

BATTLETECH™

MERCENARIES

RULEBOOK



Painted miniatures by:
Agustin Sieiro Barja
Ryan Peterson
Kenny Walch

MERCENARIES

BATTLETECH™ MERCENARIES

INTRODUCTION 3

Box Contents 3

BATTLEFIELD SUPPORT 4

THE ASSET CARD 4

TOTAL WARFARE VS.

BATTLEFIELD SUPPORT 4

BATTLEFIELD SUPPORT:

ASSETS 5

Deployment 5

Initiative 5

Movement 5

Combat 6

WHO MAKES

THE DESTROY CHECK? 7

DAMAGE TO ASSETS 7

TRACKING DAMAGE 7

Heat 8

SPECIALS 8

ADVANCED SPECIALS 9

OPTIONAL RULES 10

MERCENARIES BOX SET VS.

BATTLETECH MANUAL 10

THE STRIKE CARD 11

BATTLEFIELD SUPPORT:

STRIKES 12

Hidden Aerospace Rules (Optional) . . . 13

Offensive Aerospace Support

(Bluff) 13

Offensive Aerospace Support

(Strikes) 13

Offensive Aerospace Support

(Bombing) 13

Offensive Aerospace Support

(Strafing) 13

Defensive Aerospace Support

(Light Air Cover) 14

Defensive Aerospace Support

(Heavy Air Cover) 14

Artillery Support 14

Minefield Support 15

FORCE BUILDING 16

1. Cost Allotment 16

2. Battle Value Integration 16

Purchase Guidelines 16

CHAOS CAMPAIGN: MERCENARIES 17

BECOMING A MERCENARY 17

WHAT IS BATTLE VALUE? 17

MERCENARIES BOX SET

'MECH LIST 17

Scale 18

PLAYING A MERCENARY

CAMPAIGN 18

Reputation 19

CONTRACTS 19

General Contract Terms 19

OF MERCENARY MIND 20

CAMPAIGN FLOWCHART 20

Negotiating a Contract 21

GREAT EAGLE GARRISON 21

PEARL DRAGON RAID 22

ZONGSHAN 22

CONTRACT STEPS TABLE 23

GREAT EAGLE GARRISON AND

PEARL DRAGON RAID

MISSION BRIEF 23

CONTINUING THE MERCENARY

CAREER 25

Street War 25

URBAN MAPSHEET TABLE 23

Pirate Invasion 25

TRACKS 26

Mapsheets 26

Entering the Playing Area 26

Deploying Prior to Initiative 26

Retreat and Ending the Game 26

Salvage 26

Special Rules 26

DEFEND 27

MEETING ENGAGEMENT 27

STRIKE 27

OBJECTIVE RAID 28

TIME BETWEEN TRACKS 29

Repairs, Purchasing, Salvage,

and other Expenses 29

Personnel Training 29

Formation Training 29

SP ACTIVITY COST TABLE 30

Changing Scale 30

Warchest Debt 30

MERCENARY COMMAND

SCALE TABLE 31

Breaking Contract 31

EXAMPLE WORKSHEETS 32

CREDITS



FIND US ONLINE:

precentor_martial@catalystgamelabs.com
(e-mail address for any BattleTech questions)
<http://bg.battletech.com/>
(official BattleTech web pages)
<http://www.CatalystGameLabs.com>
(Catalyst web pages)
<http://store.catalystgamelabs.com>
(online ordering)

Printed in China.
First Printing

Published by Catalyst Game Labs,
an imprint of InMediaRes Productions, LLC.
5003 Main St. #110
Tacoma, WA 98407

BattleTech Original Design

Jordan K. Weisman
L. Ross Babcock III
Sam Lewis

BattleTech Line Developer

Ray Arrastia
Assistant Line Developer
Aaron Cahall

BattleTech Art Director

Anthony Scroggins

Project Development & Writing

Randall N. Bills
Joshua Franklin
Keith Hann

BattleTech Line Editor

Aaron Cahall
Additional Editing
Mark Riggelman

Additional Writing

Michael Ciaravella
Wunji Lau
Phil Lee
Lance Scarinci

Production Staff

Art Director
Brent Evans
BattleTech Art Director
Anthony Scroggins
Graphic Design & Layout
Ray Arrastia
David Kerber
Record Sheets
Zac Schwartz
Digital Painting
Mark Hayden

Cover Art

Marco Mazzoni
Kickstarter Exclusive
Cover Design
David Kerber

Interior Artwork

Ray Arrastia
Alan Blackwell
Dale Eadeh
Mark Hayden
Alex Iglesias
Harri Kallio
David Kerber
Darren Liang

Łukasz Matuszek
Marco Mazzoni
Florian Mellies
Thomas Moor
Marco Pennacchietti
Anthony Scroggins
Tan Ho Sim
Germán Varona
Kat Wylder

Miniatures Design Team

Art Director
Anthony Scroggins
Concept Artists
Alan Blackwell
Eldon Cowgur
Harri Kallio
Marco Mazzoni
Florian Mellies
Benjamin Myers
Anthony Scroggins
3D Sculptors
Alan Blackwell
Jordan Cuffie
Elizabeth Gibbs
Aaron Harris
Alexander Immerzeel
Sergey Kolesnik

Chris Lowrey
Anthony Scroggins
Raymond White

Battlefield Support Rules Playtesters

Alex "Highlighter" Lee, Alison "Lady Jaye" Roby, Anthony "Sparky" Gaff, Anton Bogatirev, Ashley Allensworth, August Shepherd, Aurora Shepherd, Becca "Voss" Grech, Chris "Elroy Scout", Christopher Bonafont, Claire "Bear" Leitner, Cole Rios, Colin Bullock, Cylenec, Dain Christensen, Daniel "Rodent" Collis, Daniel Shoemaker, Daniil Lutsenko, Daryk, David Dietrich, DevianID, Dillan "D.Buffalo" Williams, Emily Shepherd, Empyrus, Fear Factory, Geg, Graham Wallis, Greg "Grumpy Bear" Flesch, Hans Dietrich, Henning Boessler, IntelliWasp, Isabelle "Bizzy" Roby, Jake, "Rogue" Cipriano, Jason Faberman, Jasonf, Jonathan Lung, Jordyn Dibbs, Joshua Franklin, Justin Shepherd, Karl, Jakubowiak, Katy "Rocket" Williams, Logan Rios, Luke Fotia, Marc-André Gingras, Martin P. Robertson, Matous Vrbá, Michael Bors, Michael Vasta, Mike Oxbig, Myles "Wings" McLaughlin,

Naayeel "JoMamma" Ackon, Neil "Conellus", Brilliant, Nela Grimová, NeonKnight, Paige "Pickles" Leitner, Parker "Shugo" Gaff, Phil "Raider" Roby, pokefan548, Prometheus5, Raiden "Goatboy" Ackon, Rawbert, Reid Christensen, Rekkon, Richard Peacock, Rick "Specter", Amoroso, Rob Markowski, Ryan Voigt, Samuel Lamontagne, Santos Perona, Shawnda "Jugs" Lawrence, Stas, Vysotsky, Stas Zlenko, Stella Shepherd, Tayton "Pork Chop" Gaff, Thunder, Tom Crusade, Travis Pijut, VariousGameMasters, Viktor Walter, Weirido, William McCartney, Xan, *Scrap Metal*: Bryn Bills, Jerel Bromley, Michael Mullins, Caleb Lacy Saunders, Jared Lacy Saunders, Brian "Squared" Stewart

Chaos Campaign:

Mercenaries Playtesters

Ian "TonerVision" Apelgren, Jacob Bebbington, Billy "Faithless" Caldwell, Chris Chandler, Etienne Charron-Willard, Ian "tohuwabohu" Clark, James Connolly, Jason Faberman, Arthur Garlick, JT Garrett, Lucas (kurgan) Glass, Hari Gujral, Michael Maybury, Nick Perrin, Ed "MetalEd" Stephens, Phil Walling, Glenn Wilkinson

INTRODUCTION

Whether wet-behind-the-ears recruits or grizzled veterans, mercenaries are the wild card that can tip the balance in combat. These MechWarriors run the razor's edge between immortality and destruction, and possess the elite skills—and the right amount of luck—to snatch victory from the jaws of defeat.

There are literally hundreds of mercenary outfits, found on nearly every battlefield across the Inner Sphere and beyond. Some are elite, multi-regiment combat commands with centuries-old legacies, while others are down-on-their-luck lances that scratch out a living on backwater worlds. Will you join an existing unit, or try to carve out your own place in the universe?

This booklet expands on the rules found in the *BattleTech: A Game of Armored Combat* box set, adding Battlefield Support rules that bring vehicles, aerospace strikes, artillery, and minefields into any game, along with a campaign that will have you finding a contract and getting your mercenary unit up and running in no time.

BOX CONTENTS

Your *BattleTech: Mercenaries* box set includes:

- **Plastic Miniatures:** 12 high-quality unpainted plastic miniatures, which are ready to play without any cutting or assembly required: 8 BattleMechs and 4 vehicles.
- **Mercenaries Rulebook:** The rulebook you're currently reading, which expands on the rules found in *A Game of Armored Combat*.
- **BattleTech Primer:** This pamphlet introduces *BattleTech's* incredibly rich fictional setting, along with details about mercenaries.
- **Record Sheet Booklet:** This booklet contains 16 pre-made record sheets that correspond to the BattleMech miniatures found in this box set.
- **Worksheets:** 2 laminated worksheets allow you to easily build your command and negotiate a contract.
- **Pilot Cards:** 8 pilot cards detail a variety of mercenaries, along with the Special Pilot Abilities they bring to any battlefield.
- **Battlefield Support Cards:** 99 Battlefield Support cards cover a wide gamut of options for this rulebook. (These updated cards fully replace the previously published Battlefield Support Deck.)
- **Punchboard:** These playing pieces tie into the Battlefield Support rules and cards in this box set. The vehicle tokens provide a good spread of weight class and play type, so you can get a taste of what the rules have to offer before picking up Battlefield Support ForcePacks. Once you own those models, the tokens can be used for any models you don't have, or slip it under a model when you have two vehicles in the same hex.
- **No One Left Behind:** This short story will immerse players in the *BattleTech* universe.
- **Tables Card:** This card allows for ease of building forces and using the Battlefield Support rules on your table.
- **Dice:** The game of *BattleTech* is played using two six-sided dice.
- **Playing Maps:** The box set contains two mapsheets, with different maps printed on each side.
- **Alpha Strike Cards:** *Alpha Strike* is an alternate, fast-playing version of *BattleTech*. The rules are not included in this box set, but players can download the free *Alpha Strike Quick-Start Rules* at bg.battletech.com to give this alternate rules system a try.
- **Inner Sphere Poster:** This double-sided poster depicts a map of the Inner Sphere. One side is set in the year 3058, prior to the Civil War Era—featuring the Chaos March—and the other side is set in 3151, featuring the Hinterlands.



BATTLEFIELD SUPPORT

The Battlefield Support rules are designed for *BattleTech* players who love the idea of combined arms play but prefer to keep their game's focus on the BattleMech. Under these rules, players are encouraged to think of vehicles, artillery and various aerospace strikes as buffs to what they're already fielding: bringing combined arms flavor to a *BattleTech* game, while doing so in a way that's smooth and easy and doesn't take away from the 'Mech-vs-'Mech combat we all love.

These rules supersede the Battlefield Support rules previously published in the *BattleMech Manual (BMM)* and *Battle of Tukayyid (BoT)* sourcebook.

Battlefield Support is divided into two types:

- **Assets:** This includes the following: VTOLs; hover, wheeled and tracked vehicles; infantry; and emplacements. It does not include aerospace fighters (the effects of fighters are called Strikes; see below).
- **Strikes:** Attacking aerospace fighters, off-board artillery, and minefields are all covered under Strikes.

To incorporate these rules into the force you field for a game, see *Force Building*, page 16.

THE ASSET CARD

The following items appear on each Asset card.

1: Asset: The name of the Asset represented by the card. Under the Battlefield Support rules, the term "Asset" refers to any single battlefield "element" that has an Asset card and uses the Asset rules; i.e. vehicles, infantry, and emplacements.

2: Movement Points (MP): The Movement Points and type available to this Asset to spend each turn.

TOTAL WARFARE VS. BATTLEFIELD SUPPORT

Full *BattleTech* rules for vehicle, conventional infantry, battle armor, and aerospace fighter combat are found in *Total Warfare (TW)*, and rules for artillery and minefields are in *Tactical Operations: Advanced Rules (TO:AR)*. As noted at left, the Battlefield Support rules allow you to field such units and rules in a quicker, simpler manner, and without needing to reference a full-sized rulebook.

The Battlefield Support rules for various Assets and the "full" rules for the same unit type are independent and do not cross over. That is, infantry as found in *Total Warfare* use the rules for *Total Warfare*, and infantry Assets as presented here use the rules below. That said, these rules do not replace the *Total Warfare* rules in any way; they are simply one more option for players to maximize their enjoyment of the game.

3: TMM: Target Movement Modifier. This is the Target Number modifier applied in most cases by an attacker who selects the Asset as a target.

4: Range: All Assets have a single attack. The Range on the Asset card indicates the Short, Medium and Long Range—in hexes—for that attack. (Some Assets replace this with the name of unique attacks, such as Artillery or Arrow.)

5: Skill: This is the base target number for the Asset to hit an opponent—the lower, the better. All standard modifiers apply to the attack, except for the attacker movement modifier (for more details, see *Combat* on p. 6). The number in white is the standard Skill, while the lower value to the right in grey and in parentheses (if any) is the "Veteran" version, which costs more to field (see *Veteran Assets*, p. 5).

6: Damage (Dmg): Each successful attack by the Asset inflicts the indicated Damage Value grouping. A Dmg value such as "10x3" or "20x2" indicates that many damage value groupings are applied to different locations; i.e. 10x3 is three 10 Damage Value groupings to three rolled locations, and 20x2 is two 20 Damage Value groupings to two rolled locations. Regardless of the indicated Dmg, a successful attack applies all damage: an Asset never consults the Cluster Hits Table.

23 (27)

10

1

MAXIM

HOVER TRANSPORT

4

5

6

MP 8H

2

TMM +3

3

RANGE

3/6/9

SKILL

6 (5)

DMG

5x4

CHECK

7

THRESHOLD: 5

5

SPECIALS:

APC1, IF2

06/44

BATTLETECH

BATTLEFIELD SUPPORT

© 2023 The Topps Company. All rights reserved.

BATTLEFIELD SUPPORT

7: Destroy Check Target Number (Check): To destroy an Asset, an opponent must roll equal to or higher than this number when a Destroy Check is triggered. Regardless of how much damage is applied, and from how many sources, only a single Destroy Check is made against an Asset in a turn.

8: Degradation: If an Asset survives its Destroy Check, you subtract one from its current Destroy Check Target Number, writing the new value into this area.

9: Threshold Target Number (Threshold): This value indicates how much damage must be applied in a turn to that Asset to trigger a Destroy Check during the End Phase of that turn.

10: Battlefield Support Cost (C): An Asset's Cost measures its approximate battlefield strength. An Asset typically has two costs. The first, in white, is its standard cost. The second (if any), to the right in grey and parentheses, is its cost if it is a Veteran Asset (see *Veteran Assets*, below).

11: Specials: Some Assets possess special battlefield abilities beyond movement, damage and so on, represented by abbreviated text here. The rules for Specials are covered on page 8.

BATTLEFIELD SUPPORT: ASSETS

Assets never make Piloting or Driving Skill Rolls, even if the rules call for an Asset to automatically fail them. If performing an action requires the Asset to make a Piloting Skill Roll, the Asset cannot take that action unless the scenario specifies otherwise.

BattleTech is a large ruleset with many options and possibilities. If you encounter a situation not covered by these rules, ask yourself if the situation would require a player to track any kind of information regarding an Asset from turn to turn, beyond what is found here. If the answer is "yes," do not use that rule with regard to Assets.

Asset Tokens: Players can use the Asset tokens in this box to represent vehicles they do not have miniatures for. Additionally, they can be used when two vehicles are in the same hex; i.e. miniature on top, token below (see *Stacking Limitations*, p. 6).

Assets that are a single unit but that occupy more than one hex are known as multi-hex Assets. For example, the Long Tom is two miniatures: the miniature with the main gun occupies the primary hex, while the other miniature is always adjacent in a hex directly behind it. Multi-hex tokens include a small black hexagon on one hex. In both instances—the miniature with the main gun or the part of the token with a small black hexagon—this is the Asset's primary hex. Further details on multi-hex Assets are found below.

Infantry: Any reference to "infantry" with no further clarifier includes both conventional infantry and battle armor.

Objectives: If the scenario includes objectives, Assets never count for fulfilling objective goals (claiming a marker through presence, scanning an area, moving off a map edge, and so on) except through destruction of enemy Assets, unless the scenario specifically states otherwise.

Veteran Assets: As previously noted, most Asset cards include a grey-scaled Skill in parentheses next to the standard Skill which is lower in value by 1, used if the Asset is of Veteran quality. The drop is usually from 6 to 5, but for Emplacements, as well as Clan units such as Elementals and a few other instances, the drop is from 5 to 4. There is a corresponding grey-scaled higher Cost, in parentheses, next to the standard Cost, which is used if a player chooses to make

the Asset a Veteran. Any number of Assets can be Veteran, or not, as a player decides—and can afford. (A good way to track this on the Asset card is to circle or underline the Skill that unit actually possesses with a dry-erase marker.)

DEPLOYMENT

All Assets always deploy first during setup. Only after deployment for all Assets has been resolved is non-Asset deployment resolved, per the normal rules.

If both sides are using Assets, each side deploys half their Assets at a time (round up), following the deployment order for the scenario.

Emplacements: These are deployed like any other Asset, but can be placed anywhere more than 6 hexes outside of the opposing player's deployment zone as defined by the scenario. If the opposing player has no deployment zone (i.e. that player's Assets move onto the battlefield during the Movement Phase of Turn 1), emplacements may be placed anywhere 7 or more hexes from that player's home edge.

INITIATIVE

All Assets perform all movement actions first in each Movement Phase, following initiative order if both sides are using Assets. Only after movement for all Assets have been resolved is non-Asset movement resolved, per the normal rules.

If both sides are using Assets, use the Initiative result for the round to determine which side moves first in the phase. Each side then moves half their Assets at a time, starting with the player who lost initiative, until all Assets have been moved. If the number of Assets on a side is uneven, a player can move their larger half second (i.e., if a player has 7 Assets, they can deploy/move 3 first, and then 4 second, or vice versa).

Emplacements: When making movement selections, emplacements do not count as valid choices. For example, a force with 10 Assets, 3 of which are emplacements, has only 7 Assets for movement selection purposes (which results in a group of 3 and a group of 4).

MOVEMENT

Assets use the movement rules for BattleMechs, with the following exceptions.

Assets do not pick a movement mode at the start of the Movement Phase. Instead, they have the same fixed Movement Point allowance every turn, which is affected by terrain and other MP modifiers as normal. Assets must pay MP to change their facing just like a BattleMech. If it is ever necessary to determine an Asset's exact movement mode, assume it is running (except for Assets with jump movement, which are always considered to use Jumping MP, and emplacements, which are immobile).

Backward Movement: A player who wishes to move an Asset backward that turn must declare this at the start of the Asset's move. This reduces the Asset's Movement Points to half for that turn (round up). An Asset cannot change levels on a turn that it moves backward.

Infantry: Conventional infantry and battle armor Assets do not have a facing and so never pay MP to change their facing.

Level Changes: Unlike 'Mechs, Assets can only climb or descend one level per hex of movement; this costs 2 MP. There are

BATTLEFIELD SUPPORT

two exceptions. Assets with Jump movement (e.g. jump infantry) obey the same rules for level changes as jumping 'Mechs (see pp. 11-12, *AGoAC*), including the fact that they do not pay MP to change levels. VTOLs can change any number of levels, but pay 1 MP per level so changed (so a VTOL moving into a neighboring hex ahead of it and climbing 5 levels would pay 6 MP: 1 for the new hex, and 5 for the level change).

Urban Movement: Assets cannot enter building hexes, with the exception of VTOLs (which treat all terrain as clear and are assumed to be above the building) and infantry. Infantry Assets can enter a building hex or move from one building hex to another such adjacent hex; each such move is a full move requiring all their available MP, regardless of their base MP). Infantry can also land on a building's roof if they have jump movement and can reach it, as a normal jump move.

For full urban movement rules, see *Total Warfare*. If using those rules, Assets never skid or sideslip.

TERRAIN RESTRICTIONS AND RULES

An Asset's movement type is indicated on its card next to its MP and indicated below in parentheses.

The increased MP costs and other effects from terrain always apply to Assets (except as noted below), but terrain never forces Assets to make Piloting Skill Rolls.

- Foot (f) and jump (j) conventional infantry can enter any hex except water of Depth 1 or deeper.
- Hover vehicles (h) cannot enter woods hexes. They treat all other hexes as clear terrain.
- Tracked vehicles (t) and mechanized/motorized conventional infantry (t) cannot enter heavy woods.
- Wheeled vehicles (w) cannot enter woods, rough, or rubble hexes. A wheeled vehicle gains +1 MP if it moves entirely on a road during its Movement Phase.
- VTOL vehicles (v) treat all hexes as clear terrain.

Water: No Asset in this ruleset can enter water hexes of Depth 1 or deeper unless they treat it as clear terrain.

STACKING LIMITATIONS

Up to two friendly Assets can be in the same hex, or one Asset and one friendly 'Mech.

All non-Assets can move through a hex containing one or more Assets. In other words, Assets do not hinder the movement of enemy units, though the standard limitations involved in ending moves in enemy-occupied hexes still apply.

Infantry Stacking: Conventional infantry and battle armor Assets ignore the presence of enemy Assets of those types for stacking purposes. As a result, up to four infantry Assets can be in a single hex: two friendly, plus two enemy.

MULTI-HEX ASSETS

These Assets occupy more than one hex, though they are in all ways considered a single Asset for movement purposes. Measure all movement using only the Asset's primary hex. When a multi-hex Asset is finished its move, all hexes occupied by the Asset must be legal for that Asset type, and on the same level. Otherwise, the number of hexes the Asset occupies is not relevant during movement: assume it always maneuvers as needed to reach its destination hex. Essentially, treat such an Asset as a normal single-

hex Asset when moving it around the board, only considering the multi-hex aspect in between moves.

Any secondary hexes containing the Asset when it is not being moved are considered occupied by that Asset for stacking and other movement purposes.

COMBAT

Assets make fire selections and resolve the order of their attacks just as if they were 'Mechs.

All Assets are one level high for line of sight (LOS) purposes, except for VTOLs (see below). They never receive partial cover.

When attacking, all Assets attack during the Weapon Attack Phase and use the Skill value written on their card as their base Target Number. Each applies all standard attack modifiers except for the attacker movement modifier, which is never applied. Each Asset can only make one attack per turn, regardless of how many Damage Value groupings it applies to its target if it hits.

Unlike other Assets, the Target Movement Modifier (TMM) of an Asset is always the same: it is a fixed modifier indicated on the Asset card that applies regardless of how many hexes it has moved (even if it does not move at all). The only exceptions are when a unit is making an indirect fire attack (see below) or Artillery attack (see *Artillery*, p. 8).

Arcs: Assets do not use the standard firing arcs: their firing arc is 360 degrees. The exceptions are emplacements or any Asset with the No Turret Special, which can only fire in their forward firing arc. For such Assets, use the standard BattleMech forward firing arc.

Additionally, most Assets are easier to destroy if struck in their rear arc (see *Rear Damage*, p. 8).

Emplacements: The immobile target modifier of -4 applies to all weapon attacks against emplacements.

Simplifications: Assets do not apply attacker movement modifiers (except when calculating spotting for indirect fire), do not have minimum ranges, and do not track ammunition or heat expenditure. They cannot use special munitions.

Terrain Modifiers: An Asset applies only the higher option of its TMM or the terrain modifier of the hex it occupies, never both. If there is a tie, assume the modifier is from terrain, not TMM. For example, jump infantry (TMM +2) in heavy woods (+2 terrain modifier) has a +2 modifier from these two effects, not +4. Intervening terrain (which never includes the hex an Asset is in) is treated as normal.



BATTLEFIELD SUPPORT

VTOLs: VTOLs never receive terrain modifiers for the hex they are in. Each VTOL must always be at least one level above the hex they are in, taking into account any terrain in the hex. For example, if a VTOL is present in a Level 1 hex, it must be at least at Level 2; if above a Level 0 hex with woods (which are two levels high) or a Level 2 building, it must be at least at Level 3. Otherwise, VTOLs can be at any level, but the level of each VTOL must be indicated clearly on the table at all times. As this can be onerous to track, this should be borne in mind when purchasing and deploying VTOL Assets.

Note that level has no effect on range: a VTOL one hex away at Level 99 is still only one hex away for range purposes.

INDIRECT FIRE

An Asset with the Indirect Special can make one indirect fire attack per turn (see p. 21, *AGoAC*) in place of its regular attack. The standard rules for such are followed, with the following exceptions.

To use indirect fire, an Asset cannot expend any MP that turn. The Asset loses its TMM for that turn, but also does not count as moving when calculating its Target Number. An indirect fire attack has a range of 7/14/21, regardless of the vehicle's standard attack range. The damage from a successful indirect attack is applied in 5-point Damage Value groupings, with each grouping's location rolled separately. The number of Damage Value groupings is noted along with the Asset's Indirect Special; an Asset with IF2 rolls two groupings of 5 damage, one with IF3 rolls three, and so on.

Assets can serve as spotters for indirect fire. Assets always count as Running (+2 attacker movement modifier) for this purpose, with the exception of emplacements and infantry Assets, which are always treated as having not moved for this purpose.

MULTI-HEX ASSETS

These Assets occupy more than one hex, though they are in all ways considered a single Asset for combat purposes. Measure all ranges to and from the Asset's primary hex. Any secondary hexes occupied by the Asset are irrelevant for combat purposes. These cannot take damage, affect LOS, alter the Asset's terrain modifier, block fire, or otherwise affect combat.

PHYSICAL ATTACKS

Assets cannot charge, ram, or perform any other physical attack.

Assets (except for VTOLs) can be kicked, punched, or struck by a physical weapon or club. This damage is added to any damage from the Weapon Attack Phase to determine if a Destroy Check is made during the End Phase.

URBAN COMBAT

While an infantry Asset is inside a building (not on its roof), apply a modifier to its Destroy Check TN based on the type of building: +1 for a Light building, +2 for Medium, +3 for Heavy, and +4 for Hardened, to a maximum TN of 11+. However, any damage dealt to such an Asset by enemy infantry in the same building hex (Asset or not) negates these TN modifiers for the turn.

If players are tracking damage to buildings, a building collapse automatically destroys all infantry Assets on or within it.

For full urban combat rules, see *Total Warfare*.

WHO MAKES THE DESTROY CHECK?

If a player has only a single opponent, this isn't an issue. But what happens if each side consists of several players? Since multiple opponents may damage an Asset, and the Destroy Check is only made once during the End Phase, it may not be clear which player should make the roll. Each group should decide before the start of the game how that will work, to minimize confusion. Simply rotating from player to player each turn may be the simplest solution.

DAMAGE TO ASSETS

Assets do not have hit locations: damage dealt to an Asset is simply applied to it as a whole, ignoring any mentions of hit locations.

If an Asset takes sufficient damage in a turn, its attacker makes a Destroy Check during the End Phase. The amount of damage required to trigger this check for a given Asset type is the Threshold number listed on the Asset card (usually 5).

A Destroy Check is made by the designated attacker rolling 2D6. The Destroy Check Target Number for the check is indicated on the Asset card (noted as "Check"). The higher the Check number, the harder the Asset is to kill. If the roll result is equal to or greater than that Asset's Destroy Check TN, the Asset is destroyed.

The Destroy Check roll is modified by the total amount of damage the Asset took in the turn (all phases combined). If 11 or more points of damage was dealt to the Asset that turn, add 1 to the roll result. For every 10 full points of damage beyond that, add another 1. For example, if 0-10 points of damage was dealt to an Asset in a turn, the attacker applies no roll modifier; 11-20 points +1; 21-30 +2; and so on.

All Destroy Check modifiers are cumulative.

If triggered, **only one Destroy Check** per turn per damaged Asset is made.

Anti-Infantry Weapons: If a conventional infantry Asset takes damage from a weapon with the Anti-Infantry Weapon Type (noted as "AI" on their card or record sheet), such as a machine gun, the Asset applies 2 points of Degradation if it survives the Destroy

TRACKING DAMAGE

The Asset cards are laminated, which makes tracking damage easy. Simply keep a running total of damage applied in a turn to any Assets you control by writing it directly on the Asset card with a dry erase marker. If a Destroy Check is survived, the controlling player applies the Degradation, and then erases the tracked damage, ready for the next turn.

BATTLEFIELD SUPPORT

Check against it that turn, rather than the usual 1 point (see below). Make an "AI" note next to the damage on a conventional infantry Asset struck by such an attack, so that this fact can be recalled at the end of the turn when it is time to make the Destroy Check. Assuming the Asset survives, this note is erased along with the damage at the end of the turn.

Area-Effect Damage: AE damage, which includes all artillery and minefields, is doubled against infantry Assets.

Multi-hex Assets: Only an Asset's primary hex can take damage. If the Asset is destroyed, all elements of that Asset in neighboring hexes are destroyed as well.

Rear Damage: Double the damage of any attack that hits an Asset in its rear arc (except infantry Assets, which don't ever have a facing and thus do not have a rear arc).

DEGRADATION

If a Destroy Check fails and the Asset survives, ignore all damage the Asset took this turn in all future turns; points of damage are not tracked on Assets past the turn they were dealt. However, a failed check immediately lowers the Asset's Destroy Check TN by 1, representing the unit's loss of armor and structural integrity. Write the new value in the indicated spot on the Asset card. This is the only damage tracking that is performed on Assets from turn to turn.

An Asset whose Destroy Check TN is degraded to 2 automatically fails its next Destroy Check, regardless of modifiers.

AI Weapons: Weapons of the AI Type cause a conventional infantry Asset 2 points of degradation (see *Anti-Infantry Weapons*, above).

A Behemoth Heavy Tank has the misfortune to drive into the sights of Dean's Masakari. Two Clan ER PPCs smash into the tank for 30 damage. Then, during the Physical Attack Phase, it is kicked by a Locust IIC for 5 more points of damage. With a Threshold of 8, only 8 or more damage was required to trigger a Destroy Check, and so Dean makes a Destroy Check against the Behemoth during the End Phase. The Destroy Check TN for a Behemoth is 10. However, as it took 35 damage that round, Dean gets to add 3 to his check roll (meaning he only needs to roll a 7). A result of 10 or more, after all modifiers have been applied, means that Dean has destroyed the tank. If the tank survives, this damage is ignored in all future turns, because Assets do not track points of damage past the end of a turn. However, due to Degradation, the vehicle's Destroy Check TN permanently drops from 10 to 9 before the next turn begins: the next check made against the vehicle will see it destroyed on a result of 9 or more.

If it was a conventional infantry Asset that was struck, even a single small laser hit to it would have triggered a Destroy Check. However, as a small laser only deals 3 damage, the check would not apply any modifiers. Just like every other Asset, though, its Destroy Check TN would drop by 1 if it survives.

HEAT

Assets do not generate heat.

Advanced rules can force an Asset to gain heat through environmental effects or being hit by special weapons. If an Asset would be forced to gain heat points for any reason, every point of heat counts as 2 points of damage.

SPECIALS

Specials reflect extra features of an Asset's performance created by its equipment or Asset type. Assets may have multiple Specials.

Formation Abilities: Formation abilities and Special Pilot Abilities (see *Clan Invasion* box, pp. 20-23) do not apply to Assets.

ANTI-INFANTRY (AI)

The Asset primarily deals anti-infantry damage. Attacks by the Asset against conventional infantry obey the rules for Anti-Infantry Weapons (see *Anti-Infantry Weapons*, p. 7).

ANTI-MISSILE SYSTEM (AMS)

The vehicle has a defensive system that protects it from missile attacks. When a Cluster Hits Table roll is made against this Asset as the result of a missile attack, subtract 4 from the roll (to a minimum of 2).

ARMORED PERSONNEL CARRIER (APC X)

The Asset can carry one Foot or Jump conventional infantry Asset for each value indicated by the Special on the card (e.g. APC2 = the ability to transport two such Assets). Such infantry Assets can begin the game in the APC. While transported, they do not count as an Asset for any gameplay purpose (e.g. Initiative, and so on).

At the end of the Movement Phase, an appropriate infantry Asset can either deploy from their APC, or board any friendly APC that has the room for them. To board one, they must be in the same hex as that APC; to deploy, they must be able to be placed in the same hex as their APC. If an APC with infantry onboard is destroyed, that infantry Asset is destroyed as well (except for mechanized battle armor; see below).

Battle Armor: These Assets treat every friendly OmniMech as having the APC1 Special. As such, a battle armor Asset can board or dismount from a friendly OmniMech as if it were any other APC, and when boarded is treated in all ways as if inside an APC (including not being damaged by or absorbing fire directed at the OmniMech). If the OmniMech an Asset is riding is destroyed, the Asset takes 35 damage and is placed in the OmniMech's final hex; if this hex is illegal for the battle armor to be placed in, the Asset is destroyed.

Deployment Penalties: Infantry cannot fire on the same turn it deploys from an APC, and has a TMM of +0.

ARTILLERY (ARTILLERY (TYPE) X)

The Asset has an artillery piece, with which it can deliver one Artillery Strike every second turn. The Strike is resolved in all ways using the Artillery Strike rules (see pp. 14-15), including having a Target Number of 8 (instead of 6). However, an Artillery-equipped Asset cannot pre-designate hexes, and can only target hexes in its forward firing arc. The target hex for the Strike is secretly recorded when the attack is announced and the Strike resolved on the following turn, just like an Artillery Strike. If an Asset makes an Artillery attack, it cannot do so the next turn (the turn its attack is resolved in).

When choosing a target hex for such a Strike, no friendly Asset can be in the intended blast area at the time of firing; this includes the firing Asset. However, scatter or the one-turn delay between firing and landing can result in artillery Strikes damaging friendly Assets. Divide the scatter distance for Artillery Asset strikes by two

BATTLEFIELD SUPPORT

(rounding the result up). An Artillery Strike from an Asset cannot scatter so that the center of the blast is on or behind the firing Asset; if this would occur, reroll the scatter direction.

An Artillery Asset can either move or fire in a turn: it cannot do both. A firing Artillery Asset loses its TMM for that turn.

An Artillery Asset cannot purchase a Veteran upgrade.

COMMANDER

The Asset is equipped with highly advanced command and control equipment. Add a +1 modifier to all Initiative rolls for non-Asset units on the same side as the Commander. A Commander has no effect on Assets, and while a force may have multiple Commander Assets, the Initiative bonus is not cumulative with itself or any other Initiative bonus; multiple instances of this Special only provide redundancy.

Additionally, once per game per Commander Asset, the player may select and apply one of the following effects:

- **Communications:** One unit increases all the Long range for all its weapons by 1 until the end of the turn.
- **Navigation:** One unit can expend 1 additional Running MP.
- **Resource:** One unit may ignore the next roll imposed on it by a planetary condition (see *BMM*, p. 59, or *TO:AR*, p. 26), whether a limited-area effect or a condition in effect under the rules of the scenario.
- **Weather:** One unit may treat any weather condition (see *BMM*, p. 62 or *TO:AR*, p. 55) as one condition less for one turn, to a minimum of the lightest weather possible.

CRIT-SEEKER

If the Asset achieves a roll on the Determining Critical Hits Table, add 1 to that roll.

IMMOBILE

The Asset is immobile. It cannot leave its hex or change its facing, and all attacks against it apply the -4 immobile Target Number modifier.

INDIRECT FIRE (IF X)

The Asset can make indirect fire attacks. See *Indirect Fire*, p. 7.

MECHANIZED

The battle armor Asset can ride an OmniMech as if the 'Mech were an APC. (See *Armored Personnel Carrier*, p. 8.)

NIMBLE

These Assets have no facing: they do not need to pay MP to make facing changes and cannot take rear damage. All infantry have this Special.

NO TURRET

The Asset can only attack targets in its forward firing arc (use the standard BattleMech forward firing arc).

SPOTTER

If this Asset spots for indirect fire, it counts as having not moved that turn for the purpose of calculating indirect fire Target Number modifiers (including when spotting for Artillery Strikes; see *Targeting* p. 15). All infantry and emplacements have this Special.

SWARM

If an Asset with this Special is in a hex adjacent to a legal target and hits that target, the attacking Asset applies additional Damage Value groupings (of the same Damage Value as their default groupings).

- Conventional infantry apply one extra grouping, and can apply this bonus against 'Mechs, emplacements, and vehicles (except VTOLs).
- Battle armor apply two extra groupings. In addition to the above list of targets, battle armor can Swarm conventional infantry (but not other battle armor).

ADVANCED SPECIALS

These Specials are meant to represent the effects of advanced technologies found in books such as the *BattleMech Manual*, *Total Warfare*, and *Tactical Operations: Advanced Units and Equipment*. Some of them are more complex than standard Specials. All players must agree to the use of any units with these Specials before play begins.

ARROW IV (ARROW X)

The Asset can make a special Artillery attack each turn with its Arrow IV launcher. This attack is declared with all other attacks in the Weapon Attack Phase as usual and cannot be interrupted (just like any other declared attack). However, the controlling player does not declare a target when they declare the Arrow IV attack—only the intention to attack with it—and it is only resolved after all other attacks that phase have been made.

When resolving the Arrow IV attack, it can only attack targets that have been struck by friendly TAG this turn (see *TAG*, p. 10). If any such targets exist anywhere on the playing area, the Arrow IV attack hits one of your choice on an attack roll of 4+ on 2D6.

Because an Asset with Arrow IV can also have regular weapons, its Asset Card will have a listed Skill like any other regular Asset (even if a given variant doesn't have those extra weapons). However, an Arrow IV attack itself uses only the 4+ attack roll described above: no Target Number or Skill modifiers of any kind are applied.

If an Arrow IV attack hits, it deals 20 AE damage to the target and 5 AE damage to any other unit in the hex, friend or foe. A miss does not scatter: the attack is instead wasted with no effect.

If there is no legal target that has been struck by TAG this turn when it comes time to resolve the Arrow IV (perhaps because all TAG units missed with their attacks), the Arrow IV attack is wasted with no effect.

An Asset can either make a regular weapon or indirect fire attack (if it has any), or fire its Arrow IV: it cannot do both in the same turn. However, unlike standard Artillery, an Asset with Arrow IV can move and fire its Arrow IV in the same round.

If an Asset has multiple Arrow IV launchers, this will be indicated with a number (e.g. ARROW2). An Asset with multiple launchers can fire up to as many launchers as it has for any given attack, but all fired in a single attack must be directed against the same target. Each attack is rolled separately.

ECM (ECMX)

The Asset emits an ECM bubble equivalent to that from a Guardian ECM system (see *BMM*, pp. 112-113 or *TW*, pp. 134-135), with a radius equal to the number next to the Special—e.g.

BATTLEFIELD SUPPORT

ECM6. Regardless of the ECM ratings of any given Asset, only one Asset with an ECM Special can be purchased per force per level of Battlefield Support (e.g., one ECM Asset with Minor Support, up to four ECM Assets with Maximum Support). If players possess neither the *BattleMech Manual* nor *Total Warfare*, ignore this Special.

PROBE (PRB)

The Asset has advanced sensor gear. This Special has no effect under this ruleset; future advanced rules will detail its use.

REFLECTIVE ARMOR (RFA)

The Asset has laser-reflective armor. This Special has no effect under this ruleset; future advanced rules will detail its use.

TAG

Short for Target Acquisition Gear, any target hit by a weapon attack from an Asset with TAG is also spotted for indirect fire (see p. 7). When calculating Target Number modifiers for such an indirect fire attack, the spotting Asset that hit with TAG counts as not having moved this turn. Lastly, a successful attack that turns by an Asset with TAG is required to hit with an Arrow IV attack (see p. 9).

TARGETING COMPUTER (TC)

This Special represents advanced targeting equipment or especially accurate weaponry. It has no in-game effect by itself, but is simply a way of noting that the Skill of the Asset has been improved over the standard rating for both regular and (Veteran) units. For example, a Patton XL Tank has a Skill of 5 (4) instead of the usual 6 (5).

OPTIONAL RULES

The Assets and Specials in this section create interesting effects, but do not fit the default timescale of 10 seconds per turn that *BattleTech* uses. If players do not mind sacrificing realism for further gameplay choices, the following “cinematic” options are available.

If using Ammo Containers, Parts Caches or Field Hospitals tokens, deploy them as you would emplacements (see p. 5); this does not apply to MASH Trucks, which have their own cards. These tokens can be attacked in the same way as any other Asset; each has a Destroy Check TN of 7 and a Threshold of 5; Degradation is ignored. Like emplacements, they are immobile targets and suffer the same -4 Target Number modifier.

MERCENARIES BOX SET VS BATTLEMECH MANUAL

The Battlefield Support: Strike rules were originally published in the *BattleMech Manual* (where they were simply called the *Battlefield Support* rules). Most of those same rules are included here, minus a handful of advanced rulebook items, for two reasons. First, to ensure that all Battlefield Support rules for this box and ForcePacks are in a single location for ease of reference. Also, the costs originally listed in the *BattleMech Manual* have been adjusted to work alongside the *Battlefield Support: Assets* rules.

Ammo Container Asset (4 BSPs): In the End Phase, if a non-Asset unit that tracks ammunition is adjacent to an Ammo Container, the unit's controller picks one weapon and rolls 2D6. On a result of 8 or better, that weapon has two shots added, up to the maximum number of shots the unit can carry for that weapon. If there is more than one applicable ammo bin for the weapon, the unit's controller picks the bin(s) the shots are added to. Only one unit can attempt to draw on any single Ammo Container each turn.

Parts Cache Asset (4 BSPs): In the End Phase, if a non-Asset unit is adjacent to a Parts Cache and has one or more destroyed components (a weapon or piece of equipment, such as AMS or TAG, but not a standard structural item such as an engine or hip actuator), the unit's controller picks one such component and rolls 2D6. On a result of 8 or better, all of that component's critical slots are repaired and the component is once again functional. If the component was in a location that was destroyed, it cannot be repaired. Only one unit can attempt to draw on any single Parts Cache each turn.

Flatbed Truck Asset (4 BSPs): A Flatbed Truck extends the effects of Ammo Containers, Parts Caches, and Assets with the MASH modifier (see below) by two hexes, as long as the truck is within five hexes. If a Flatbed is within five hexes of more than one applicable Asset, its controller must pick one to receive the range extension that turn.

Treat a Flatbed Truck as a Galleon Light Tank Asset with no weapons.

MASH Special: This Special represents an Asset with advanced medical equipment, allowing it to heal MechWarriors and conventional infantry Assets that are in the same hex or adjacent hexes. For each level of MASH the Asset has, up to two friendly MechWarriors or conventional infantry Assets within range that did not attack that turn can be healed in the End Phase. For MechWarriors, roll 2D6 for each MechWarrior being treated: on a result of 7 or better, they heal one hit taken. For conventional infantry, no roll is required: increase their Destroy Check TN by up to 2 (this cannot raise the infantry Asset's Destroy Check TN above its starting value). The cost for typical MASH Assets is as follows:

- MASH Truck: see Asset Card.
- Closed Field Hospital: 3 BSPs
- Open Field Hospital: 4 BSPs

A standard MASH Truck has one level of MASH, Closed Field Hospitals have two levels, and Open Field Hospitals have three levels.



BATTLEFIELD SUPPORT

THE STRIKE CARD

Strike cards contain the data on the Battlefield Support: Strikes table (see p. 12). The information on the table makes it easy to reference all options during force building, while the cards enable quick and easy play during your game.

There are two general types of cards for data presentation: Air Cover (Defensive Aerospace), and all other cards. Light and Heavy Air Cover simply lists the Target Numbers for each type of Offensive Aerospace, while all other cards are variations of the same format:

- 1: Strike:** The name of the Strike represented by the card.
- 2: Support Type:** The classification of the Strike.
- 3: Target Number:** Players roll 2D6, comparing the result against the Target Number for that Strike, to determine whether the attack is successful. Rolling equal to or higher than the Target Number means success.
- 4: Damage Value Groupings:** If an attack is successful, all Damage Value groupings are applied. This can be split into multiple values, representing additional damage applied to adjacent hexes to the target hex.
- 5: Weapon Type:** The type of damage applied, if any; usually "AE" for area-effect.
- 6: Diagrams:** If a Strike involves a radius of damage and the potential for scatter, those diagrams will be included on the card as a reminder of those rules.
- 7: Battlefield Support Point Cost:** A Strike's Battlefield Support Point Cost measures its approximate battlefield strength. (The card does not list the Battle Values, as shown on the table, if using that value when force building; see p. 16.)



1 STRAFING **22** **7**

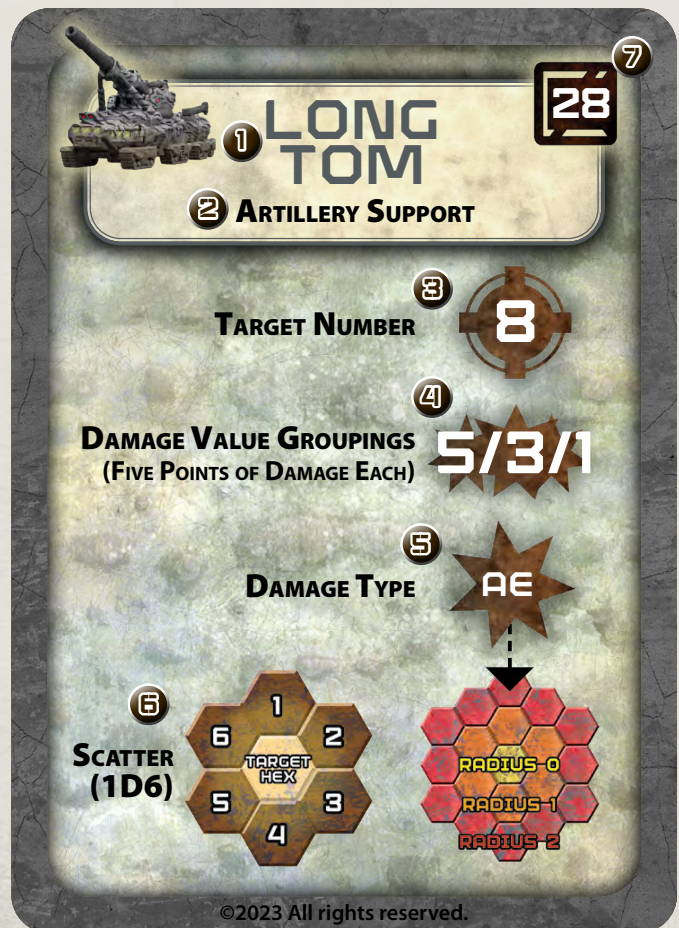
2 OFFENSIVE AEROSPACE SUPPORT

3 TARGET NUMBER **7**

4 DAMAGE VALUE GROUPINGS (FIVE POINTS OF DAMAGE EACH) **3**

5 DAMAGE TYPE **DE**

©2023 All rights reserved.



1 LONG TOM **28** **7**

2 ARTILLERY SUPPORT

3 TARGET NUMBER **8**

4 DAMAGE VALUE GROUPINGS (FIVE POINTS OF DAMAGE EACH) **5/3/1**

5 DAMAGE TYPE **AE**

6 SCATTER (1D6)

7 RADIUS-0
8 RADIUS-1
9 RADIUS-2

©2023 All rights reserved.

BATTLEFIELD SUPPORT

BATTLEFIELD SUPPORT: STRIKES

With the exception of Minefields (see p. 15), use the following rules when declaring a Strike:

- Strikes can be used during the Weapon Attack Phase.
- If a player wishes to use one or more Strikes, they must declare their use during the Attack Declaration portion of the Weapon Attack Phase of the turn they will be used. The player reveals their selection and use of that Strike. If they purchased multiple instances of that same Strike, they do not need to reveal the full number of that Strike which they purchased but are not using.
- The controlling player declares the target hex for the attack; in the case of Strafing attacks, the player must designate multiple hexes (see *Strafing*, p. 13).

- Though the use of all Strikes must be announced during Attack Declaration, a player can execute their Strikes at any time during the Weapon Attack Phase. A limit of three Strikes (not including minefields, bluffs, or air cover) can be made per player per turn. Artillery Strikes are counted as made when they are fired, not the turn that they are landing.

Assets: While the Strike rules reference 'Mechs, they equally apply to Assets, if those are in use.

Attack Direction: If a Strike is successful, roll 1D6: on a result of 1–4, all Damage Value groupings in the attack hit the front; on a result of 5–6, they all hit the rear. There are exceptions to this rule, such as artillery, scattering, and minefields; see below.

Damage Value Groupings: If an attack is successful, all Damage Value groupings are applied, but a separate hit location roll is made

BATTLEFIELD SUPPORT: STRIKES

Support Type	Target Number	Damage Value Groupings	Weapon Type	Battlefield Support Point (BSP) Cost	Battle Value
<i>Offensive Aerospace Support</i>					
Bluff	—	—	—	5	100
Light Air Strike	5	2	N/A	9	180
Light Bombing [†]	6	3	AE	12	240
Heavy Air Strike	6	4	N/A	16	320
Heavy Bombing [†]	7	6	AE	20	400
Strafing	7	3	DE	22	440
<i>Defensive Aerospace Support</i>					
Light Air Cover		N/A	N/A	5	100
Light Air Strike/Bombing	4				
Heavy Air Strike	9				
Strafing/Heavy Bombing	11				
Heavy Air Cover		N/A	N/A	8	160
Light Air Strike/Bombing	9				
Heavy Air Strike	5				
Strafing/Heavy Bombing	6				
<i>Artillery Support[†]</i>					
Thumper	8	3/1 ^{††}	AE	12	240
Sniper	8	4/2 ^{††}	AE	18	360
Long Tom	8	5/3/1 ^{††}	AE	28	560
<i>Minefield Support</i>					
Light Density	9	2	AE	4	80
Medium Density	8	4	AE	8	160
Heavy Density	7	6	AE	12	240

*No modifiers are applied to this Target Number, except for Artillery Support (see p. 14).

**All Damage Value groupings are five points of damage.

[†]Scatters if misses; see page 13.

^{††}Affects multiple hexes; see Artillery Support, page 15.

BATTLEFIELD SUPPORT

for each grouping. Each Damage Value grouping noted on the Battlefield Support: Strikes table consists of 5 damage. For example, the Heavy Bombing has five Damage Value groupings, so it would apply a total 25 points of damage, in five Damage Value groupings of 5 damage each.

Target Number: No modifiers are applied to the Target Numbers shown on the Battlefield Support: Strikes table. Players simply roll 2D6, comparing the result against the Target Number for that Strike, to determine whether the attack is successful.

Water: If a target is fully submerged in water, it cannot be the target of any Strike. If a bombing or artillery attack scatters onto a target submerged in water, or attempts to damage such a target in any way, it is ignored.

In the case of a 'Mech standing in Depth 1 water, any damage is applied using the Punch Hit Location Table (after rolling 1D6 to determine attack direction as normal).

Weapon Type: Weapon Types are found on most unit record sheets but are not a part of standard AGOAC play (see AGOAC rulebook, p. 4). Many Strikes have the AE type, meaning "Area-Effect" (see p. 113, *TW*, or p. 96, *BMM*). If players lack those rulebooks, listed Weapon Types on Strikes may be ignored except for the additional damage caused by AE weapons to infantry (see *Damage to Assets*, p. 7).

HIDDEN AEROSPACE RULES (OPTIONAL)

All players must agree to the use of these optional rules before BSP purchases begin.

Under the standard Battlefield Support rules, players reveal all of the Offensive Aerospace Support cards they wish to use in a turn, then their opponent chooses which Defensive Aerospace Support cards they wish to use (if any), and against which revealed Offensive Aerospace Support cards.

Under these optional rules, a player places all of the Offensive Aerospace Support card attacks they wish to make in a turn face down on the table. Their opponent then selects any Defensive Aerospace Support card(s) they wish to use and places the card(s) face down next to the hidden Offensive Aerospace Support card their card(s) will target. Once all cards have been placed, they are revealed and the rules proceed as normal.

The use of these rules enables the purchase of the Bluff Offensive Aerospace Support card (see below).

OFFENSIVE AEROSPACE SUPPORT (BLUFF)

Target Number: N/A

Effect: This is not an attack. Each side can only have one Bluff card per game. This card can only be purchased if the optional *Hidden Aerospace Rules* are in play (see above).

The Bluff card may be placed face down like any other Offensive Aerospace Support card. However, when it is revealed, nothing occurs; the Bluff card and any Defensive Aerospace Support cards assigned to it are discarded without effect. No rolls are required.

OFFENSIVE AEROSPACE SUPPORT (STRIKES)

Light Air Strike Target Number: 5

Heavy Air Strike Target Number: 6

Successful Attack: If the attack is successful, make a separate roll on the appropriate Hit Location column for each Damage Value grouping.

Unsuccessful Attack: No effect.

OFFENSIVE AEROSPACE SUPPORT (BOMBING)

Light Bombing Target Number: 5

Heavy Bombing Target Number: 7

Successful Attack: If the attack is successful, make a separate roll on the appropriate Hit Location column for each Damage Value grouping.

If the hex targeted by a bombing is a building hex, and there is a 'Mech in that building hex, the full damage is applied simultaneously to both the building and the 'Mech.

Unsuccessful Attack: If the attack fails, it will scatter. Determine the Margin of Failure (MoF) between the modified Target Number and the die roll result. For each MoF point, the bombing attack will scatter one hex.

Next, roll 1D6 and compare it to the Scatter Diagram (see p. 14) to determine where the attack lands. If there is a 'Mech in that hex, even a friendly 'Mech, it is automatically hit; use the rules above for applying damage, but use a direction of attack as coming from the original targeted hex (i.e. do not roll the 1D6 to determine attack direction as for a normal attack).

OFFENSIVE AEROSPACE SUPPORT (STRAFING)

Strafing Target Number: 7

Upon the declaration of a strafing attack, the controlling player must designate from one to five consecutive hexes, all in a straight line. When resolving the attack, the player makes a separate attack roll for every 'Mech in one of those five targeted hexes, against the Strafing Target Number of 7.

Successful Attack: If the attack is successful, make a separate roll on the appropriate Hit Location column for each Damage Value grouping. If more than one target was successfully struck, then the three Damage Value groupings of a Strafing attack hit each target; i.e. if the player successfully strikes four targets with a Strafing attack, all four targets would be each be hit by three Damage Value groupings, with the attacker resolving hit locations for each grouping. (Remember to first roll 1D6 to determine whether each attack strikes the front or rear of the 'Mech).

Unsuccessful Attack: If the attack fails in a hex, nothing occurs, but attacks in other hexes are unaffected.

BATTLEFIELD SUPPORT

DEFENSIVE AEROSPACE SUPPORT (LIGHT AIR COVER)

Light Air Strike/Bombing Target Number: 4

Heavy Air Strike Target Number: 9

Strafing/Heavy Bombing Target Number: 11

This Strike is not an attack. Instead, it can potentially nullify an Offensive Aerospace Support attack.

After a player announces all Offensive Aerospace Support they wish to use in a given turn, an opponent may reveal their selection(s) of a Defensive Aerospace Support (Light Air Cover) to attempt to negate the attack(s). Before the attacker makes their roll, the defender rolls against a Target Number based upon the specific attack, as noted in this entry.

If a player reveals more than one Defensive Aerospace Support, they may choose to assign them all to a single attack, or if there are multiple attacks, they may split them up in any fashion. However, all such designations must be announced before any rolls are made.

Successful Roll: If the roll is successful, the opponent's Aerospace Support attack is completely nullified; no roll is made by the attacker, and their Aerospace Support selection is considered spent.

Unsuccessful Roll: If the roll fails, the attacking player resolves their attack as normal.

DEFENSIVE AEROSPACE SUPPORT (HEAVY AIR COVER)

Light Air Strike/Bombing Target Number: 9

Heavy Air Strike Target Number: 5

Strafing/Heavy Bombing Target Number: 6

This is not an attack. Instead, it can potentially nullify an Offensive Aerospace Support attack.

After a player announces all Offensive Aerospace Support they wish to use in a given turn, an opponent may reveal their selection(s) of a Defensive Aerospace Support (Heavy Air Cover) to attempt to negate the attack(s). Before the attacker makes their roll, the defender rolls against a Target Number based upon the specific attack, as noted directly above.

If a player reveals more than one Defensive Aerospace Support, they may choose to assign them all to a single attack, or if there are

multiple attacks, they may split them up in any fashion. However, all such designations must be announced before any rolls are made.

Successful Roll: If the roll is successful, the opponent's Aerospace Support attack is completely nullified; no roll is made by the attacker and their Aerospace Support selection is considered spent.

Unsuccessful Roll: If the roll fails, the attacking player resolves their attack as normal.

ARTILLERY SUPPORT

Base Artillery Target Number: 8 (see below)

Pre-designated Hexes: Before scenario deployment begins, each side using Artillery Strikes secretly chooses five hexes on the playing area for each Artillery selection (hexes cannot be shared between Artillery Strike selections). These are pre-plotted hexes. When the Artillery Strike is made, if it is fired at one of the five pre-plotted hexes it automatically hits; i.e. no roll against a Target Number is made and no scatter occurs, the attack is simply announced and damage assigned (as noted below). There is still a one-turn delay between firing and the strike as normal (see below).

Note that this number of hexes is intended for a playing area composed of four paper maps (or two BattleMats or one



• SCATTER DIAGRAM •

During the current turn, Chris reveals that he'll be attempting to make Light Bombing, Heavy Air Strike, and Strafing Aerospace Support attacks. With all of Chris' Strike attacks for this turn announced, Kevin reviews the battlefield. His 'Mechs are currently in bad condition and lined up perfectly for that strafing run; this could push him over the edge into defeat. He decides to reveal Defensive Aerospace Support: one Light Air Cover and one Heavy Air Cover.

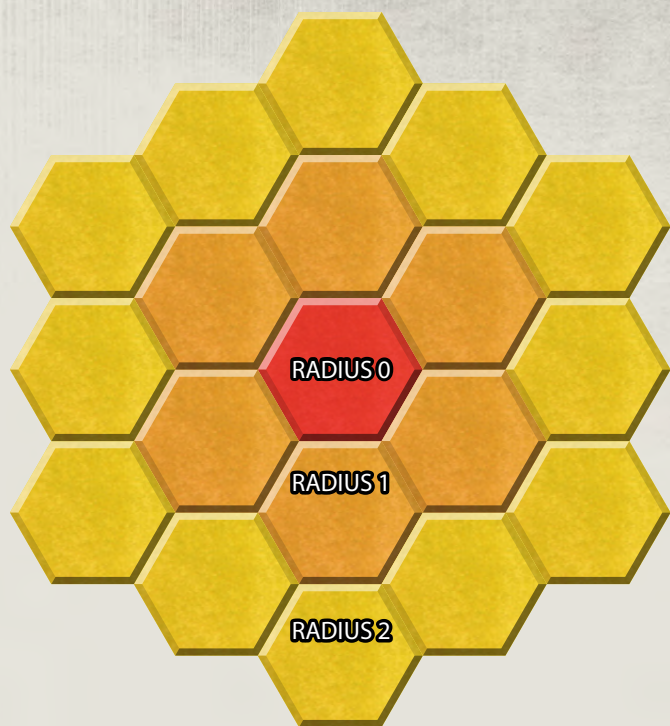
Kevin knows he could assign both Support types to try and take down the Strafing attack, but he's hurting enough that he needs to knock out two of the three attacks. He maximizes his chances against the Strafing attack by announcing he'll assign his Heavy Air Cover there, and then assigns his Light Air Cover to the Heavy Air Strike.

Kevin first rolls his Heavy Air Cover for the Strafing attack, needing a 6. He gets a 7! The Strafing attack is shot down with no further effects. Kevin's Target Number to take down the Heavy Air Strike with his Light Air Cover is 9; he rolls a 5, so the attack will still happen.

Now Chris rolls for the Heavy Air Strike, and gets a 7; this beats the Target Number by 1, so he'll be rolling for four Damage Value groupings on the target. Ouch!

Finally, Chris only needs to roll a 5 to hit with his Light Bombing attack, but rolls a 2! The attack misses the intended target hex. Because it's a bombing attack, it scatters (in this instance, three hexes: the Margin of Failure of the dice roll). Any target, friend or foe, in the hex it scatters to will automatically be attacked by the Light Bombing.

BATTLEFIELD SUPPORT



• RADIUS DIAGRAM •

BFM BattleMat). For every two additional maps used, add three additional pre-plotted target hexes per Artillery Strike selection. However, regardless of the size of the playing area, no player can place more than five pre-plotted hexes per mapsheet (an area 17 hexes long by 15 hexes wide). These limits apply regardless of how many Artillery Strikes are in use by either side.

Targeting: When targeting a hex that has not been pre-designated, use the following rules.

During any turn's Weapon Attack Phase, the player must announce that a Strike is incoming and secretly write down the target hex number. The artillery attack arrives during the Weapon Attack Phase of the *following* turn, at which time the player rolls to determine if the attack successfully strikes the targeted hex.

If a 'Mech chooses to spot the target hex for indirect fire on both the turn the artillery attack was launched and the turn on which it arrives, apply a -2 Target Number modifier to the artillery attack.

The spotter can spot for any number of Strikes (as well as indirect fire attacks) against a single hex, but can only spot to one such hex in a turn. If a spotter makes any attacks during the Weapon Attack Phase of a turn that it also spots, apply a +1 Target Number modifier to those attacks, as well as applying only a -1 (in place of the -2) modifier for targeting to the Strike attack.

Successful Attack: If the attack is successful, the first number of Damage Value groupings in the Damage Value Grouping column on the Battlefield Support: Strikes table (see p. 12) is applied to targets in the target hex. The second number of groupings is then applied to all targets in all adjacent hexes. If a third value is listed, it is applied to all targets in the adjacent hexes to those; see the Radius Diagram, page 15.

In the case of the first target hex, make a separate roll on the appropriate column for each Damage Value grouping, after rolling the 1D6 to determine whether the attack will strike the 'Mech's front or rear.

For the second (and third) radius of hexes, the direction of the attack for determining hit locations is based upon the central target hex; then roll for each Damage Value grouping.

If a building hex is damaged by artillery, and there are 'Mechs in the building, the full damage is applied simultaneously to the Assets and the building (if damage to buildings is being tracked in that scenario).

Unsuccessful Attack: If the attack fails, it scatters. Determine the Margin of Failure (MoF) between the Target Number and the die roll result. The artillery attack will scatter one hex for each MoF point. Next, roll 1D6 and compare it to the Scatter Diagram (see p. 14) to determine where the shot lands. Any 'Mechs in any of those hexes, including friendly 'Mechs, as well as terrain and buildings are automatically hit. Use the rules above for applying damage, with the direction of attack for the new target hex coming from the original targeted hex (once again, do not roll the 1D6 for a normal attack).

MINEFIELD SUPPORT

Light Density Target Number: 9

Medium Density Target Number: 8

Heavy Density Target Number: 7

Unlike all other Strikes, minefields are not an attack declared during the Weapon Attack Phase.

During each Movement Phase, a minefield's controlling player secretly tracks if any 'Mechs enter a hex with a minefield. When a 'Mech—either enemy or friendly—enters a minefield hex, any player controlling a minefield in that hex immediately announces the presence of any minefields there and rolls against the listed Target Number(s). In all instances, each minefield is resolved separately.

If a 'Mech enters a minefield hex along the ground for any reason (including via displacement), the minefield's controlling player must immediately announce its presence and make an attack roll. 'Mechs expending Jumping MP only trigger a minefield if they end their movement in a minefield hex.

Pre-designated Hexes: At the start of the game, prior to any unit deployment, a player who has selected one or more Minefield Strikes writes down the hex number, corresponding to the map, which contains each minefield selection. The player can designate any full hex anywhere on the playing area, except water hexes.

The maximum number of minefield Damage Value groupings that can be placed in a single hex by a single player is 6. However, both sides can have a minefield in the same hex. In other words, a player could only place a single Heavy Density minefield in a hex, but could instead place three Light Density fields, or a Light and a Medium Density field. In all those instances, two sets of each combination could be present in a given hex, one for each side of the game.

If a pre-designated hex has an emplacement Asset placed on it, the minefield is nullified with no effect.

Successful Attack: If the attack succeeds, roll on the front column of the Kick Location Table for each Damage Value grouping.

If a minefield is triggered and inflicts damage against a target, reduce the minefield's total Damage Value groupings by 1;

BATTLEFIELD SUPPORT



if a minefield's Damage Value groupings are reduced to 0, it has no further effect in play.

Unsuccessful Attack: If the attack fails, unlike other Battlefield Support types, the minefield stays active. Players may agree to place a counter to designate that the hex contains a minefield; or, if both players agree, they can decide to not place counters in such instances to enhance a "fog-of-war" aesthetic.

Clearing Minefields: A player may use artillery attacks (from either Strikes or Assets) or an LRM-20 to try and clear a minefield. The player must specifically designate the attack as intending to clear the minefield. When the attack hits the hex, the player rolls 2D6. On a result of 5 or better, the strike reduces the Damage Value groupings of all minefields in the hex, enemy and friendly, to 0.

Any time the target hex of an artillery attack (not any adjacent hexes) contains a minefield, even if the artillery was not designated to clear the minefield, the artillery's controller rolls 2D6. On a result of 10+, the minefield is cleared.

In all instances, minefields cleared in this fashion do not explode.

FORCE BUILDING

There are two ways to incorporate Assets and Strikes when building your force before a scenario: Cost Allotment and Battle Value Integration.

1. COST ALLOTMENT

This method assumes both players will field Battlefield Support elements (whether Assets or Strikes), with each side given an equal amount to spend. If a scenario does not provide details for Battlefield Support, then the players must determine the amount of Battlefield Support Points (BSPs) available to each player before the game begins:

- **Minor Support:** 64 BSPs
- **Moderate Support:** 96 BSPs
- **Heavy Support:** 128 BSPs
- **Maximum Support:** 192 BSPs

Note that if purchasing artillery (see p. 14) or minefields (see p. 15), these Strikes have pre-game requirements in terms of recording positions before play begins; see the *Pre-designated Hexes* section in each entry for details.

2. BATTLE VALUE INTEGRATION

While the even allocation of Battlefield Support Points to both sides is the easiest method to include Assets and Strikes, it doesn't allow for asymmetrical play, in which one side selects a different amount of Battlefield Support than the other, or none at all.

To allow for this asymmetric play style, each Battlefield Support Point equals 20 Battle Value (BV). For example, as noted on the Strikes table, a Light Air Strike Aerospace Support costs 240 BV and a Medium Density Minefield costs 200 BV, while a Maxim Hover Transport Asset would then cost 460 BV. Using this conversion rate, players can freely mix Assets and Strikes with units and other elements costing Battle Value as desired. In such a case, the scenario typically has a Battle Value cap that determines the amount of resources each player has available.

PURCHASE GUIDELINES

Once players determine how they are incorporating Battlefield Support elements, they select the appropriate Asset and Strike cards they will use in the scenario. There is no limit to the number of times a player may select a particular Asset or Strike, as long as they can afford it. If a player wishes to purchase more of a given Asset or Strike than is available in cards and counters, feel free to track the purchase and gameplay in another way.

Players do not need to spend their full BSP allotment, but unspent BSPs are lost once play begins; they may not be used to purchase Battlefield Support during the game.

For example, if a player has access to Heavy Support (128 BSPs), they could simply purchase four Behemoth Heavy Tank Assets (128 BSPs). Alternatively, they could diversify and select a Light Bombing (12 BSPs), 1 Long Tom Strike (28 BSPs), 8 Light Density Minefield Strikes (4 BSPs each for a total of 32), two Galleon Light Tank Assets (13 BSPs each for a total of 26) and a Veteran Manticore Heavy Tank Asset (24 BSPs), with 6 BSPs left unspent, which they can ignore or spend on any final options that cost 6 or less. If the players opted to select Assets and Strikes with the Battle Value Integration method, and one side took two Behemoth tanks, those Assets would cost 1,280 BV as part of their force.

As with any rules, players should understand and agree on the potential extremes before play begins. For example, if the Maximum Support option is used, a player might select and have to track 27 Foot Infantry Assets or 38 Light Density Minefields—potentially annoying and unbalancing, unless their opponent agrees to that style of play.

MERCENARIES

CHAOS CAMPAIGN: MERCENARIES

Welcome to the life of a mercenary! You know how to pilot your 'Mech and perhaps can even hit a target once in a while. Now it's time to earn your keep and do some work out there. In this *Chaos Campaign: Mercenaries*, you start with a brand-new mercenary command. Find a contract, complete the mission, earn rewards, and prosper. Or take your licks and join the Dispossessed.

The system starts with each player building their own force of mercenaries. With each player ready for action, you then need a contract. Contracts are a campaign that sets where you are going to fight and why. The contract also determines how you are paid. Contracts are often in pairs, one contract for each side, and each player may separately negotiate the terms for the various pay, support, and other rights of their contract. After all players have negotiated the contract, it will list what tracks to play out the contract. Tracks are individual missions or battles. These are usually a single session playing *BattleTech*, with an opposing force to defeat and objectives to complete. There may also be complications like weather or bad intel. Successfully completing tracks will lead to bonus payments, increased Reputation, salvage, and hopefully less losses from your command. Failure will lower your Reputation and lead to struggles keeping your command equipped. Between tracks, the Chaos Campaign handles repairs, replacements, expansion, training, and other maintenance of your command. There may be multiple tracks for a contract, and when the contract ends, it is time to search for a new contract.

Upcoming products will expand on the *Chaos Campaign: Mercenaries* system with additional contracts and rules for creating your own contracts.

BECOMING A MERCENARY

You start *Chaos Campaign: Mercenaries* with 3,000 Battle Value (BV) to spend on one or two 'Mechs. You may select any 'Mech and variant from the box sets or Force Packs you have. You must have one 'Mech; you can have two. You cannot go over 3,000 BV. The Mercenaries Box Set 'Mech List table is a quick reference for these units' BVs.

SKILLS

Each 'Mech starts with 4 Gunnery and 5 Piloting, but you start with two Skill Advances to improve (lower) your starting Skills. You cannot apply more than one Skill Advance to a single Skill at this point. You can lower your Gunnery and Piloting by one each, or you can lower your Gunnery by one and your friend's (if you got a second 'Mech) Gunnery Skill by one, and so on.

BATTLEFIELD SUPPORT

In addition to your 'Mechs, you have available an allotment of Battlefield Support. You receive 32 Battlefield Support Points (BSP) to use each game (track). You also receive any unused BV of your 3,000 BV converted to additional BSP, at a rate of 20 unused BV to 1 BSP (round down). You can convert up to 640 BV to +32 BSP, at Scale 1 (see *Scale*, p. 18). This is calculated each track, compare the

WHAT IS BATTLE VALUE?

For those coming directly to this box set from *A Game of Armored Combat*, Battle Value is the primary balancing mechanism of *BattleTech*. Every unit's record sheet lists its BV, which provides a comparison battlefield value. The BV listed on a sheet assumes a standard Gunnery 4 and Piloting 5. As those values are modified up and down, the BV of the unit is adjusted. This understanding is enough for you to use this box set, alongside the masterunitlist.info website; if you're looking for expanded details, those are found in *Total Warfare* and *TechManual*.

MERCENARIES BOX SET 'MECH LIST

Name	Model	Battle Value
Flea	FLE-17	510
Flea	FLE-21	826
Chameleon	CLN-7V	1,042
Quickdraw	QKD-5M	1,237
Ostsol	OTL-5M	1,245
Chameleon	CLN-8V	1,426
Starslayer	STY-3C	1,508
Ostsol	OTL-8E	1,552
Caesar	CES-3R	1,578
Caesar	CES-5R	2,192
Starslayer	STY-4C	2,218
Quickdraw	QKD-9G	2,224
Devastator	DVS-2	2,481

forces you are bringing to the BV limit of 3,000 BV, and receive the remaining unused BV to BSP for that track.

Note that the terms "Battlefield" and "Support" are both used in a variety of ways in these rules. However, only when they are both together (i.e., Battlefield Support) do they mean the rules provided earlier in this book.

WARCHEST

Your company starts with a Warchest of 3,000 Support Points (SP). You will use this Warchest to maintain your company and pay for any new additions (see p. 29). You also start with a Reputation of 1.

Congratulations, you have a mercenary command. Time to get a job.

CHAOS CAMPAIGN: MERCENARIES

SCALE

As you progress in your mercenary campaign, you may, hopefully, find your mercenary command growing into an actual company or even larger (see *Changing Scale*, p. 30). We track this as the Scale of the force. Your initial Scale is 1.

Note that as you gain or lose units from your force, each track you are still limited to 3,000 BV at Scale 1. To use more units (more BV) in a track, you must increase your Scale. Additional units are still useful, even without a Scale increase, for being able to select appropriate units based on track objectives or to insure you can handle battle losses and still field a full force the next track.

Arthur is ready for a mercenary campaign. He wants a strong, tough unit for his commander and goes with the Caesar CES-3R at 1,587 BV. This gives him 1,413 BV remaining. He will like something faster for grabbing loot, scanning, or other objectives. He takes an Ostsol OTL-5M at 1,245 BV. The remaining 168 BV is converted to 8 additional Battlefield SPs. Adding this to the initial 32 BSP gives Arthur 40 BSP total for the first track.

After reviewing the Battlefield Support rules and cards, Arthur plans for a pair of Galleon GAL-100 assets at 15 BSP each and a Light Air Strike at 10 BSP. The Galleons can either perform reconnaissance, support the Ostsol in quick strikes, or maneuver into the rear of any tough unit threatening the Caesar. The Air Strike can be called in to finish off enemy units or objectives as needed.

Arthur has two Skill Advances to apply. He assigns one to lower the Caesar's Gunnery from 4 to 3. Precise firepower is the dream of any mercenary. The second Skill Advance is used to lower the Ostsol's Piloting from 5 to 4. This will hopefully allow the Ostsol to get in and out.

Arthur marks down the 3,000 SP as the beginning Warchest, the initial Scale of 1, and the initial Reputation of 1 on the Mercenary Force Record sheet. The final step is naming his mercenary company, and the Henshin Tigers have registered as a new mercenary command!

Arthur's mercenary life continues on page 21 as he negotiates his first contract.

PLAYING A MERCENARY CAMPAIGN

Chaos Campaign: Mercenaries play is built around contracts, to set the general terms of the upcoming conflict and the terms of payment for the mercenary. After accepting a contract, each month may generate one of the available tracks (a game session) for the terms of that battle. Each track provides a general framework to help players create the Attacking and Defending forces and add battlefield conditions and objectives.

TERMINOLOGY

These rules use the following terminology:

- **Unit:** Whenever the term unit is used, it refers to a single game piece. In other words, a BattleMech, vehicle, or battle armor squad.
- **Force:** The term "force" refers to the total collection of units that a given side has available.
- **Contract:** A collection of negotiable terms for pay and rights, and determines the tracks and conditions for battle.
- **Month:** The standard for tracking time within the campaign. Salaries and Maintenance must be paid each month, and the contract has a Base Pay to cover most or all of this amount or even a bonus on top. There may be one or more tracks each month.



CHAOS CAMPAIGN: MERCENARIES

- **Track:** A singular battle scenario (game session). The track determines the objectives, deployment, and setup of the battle. Each track has objectives, and mercenaries are paid combat bonuses for each track with higher bonuses for successfully completing the objectives.
- **Support Points:** A representation of the funds and other assets the player has to maintain, transport, repair, purchase, or improve their mercenary company.

REPUTATION

Every mercenary wants a good Reputation. The better the mercenary's Reputation, the more leverage they have in contract negotiation. The starting Reputation is 1. Reputation is then gained on successful completion of tracks during a contract or lost by failing to succeed. A successful track is one in which the mercenary achieves a higher total points award from completing objectives in the track than their opponent. A successful track increases the mercenary's Reputation by 1. An unsuccessful track decreases the mercenary's Reputation by 1. A tie does not change Reputation. Breaching the contract (leaving the contract location before the end of contract, or just refusing to even attempt the objectives) decreases the mercenary's Reputation by 3.

Negative Reputation has no effect other than to require the mercenary to gain more Reputation in order to reach positive effects.

CONTRACTS

The heart of surviving as a mercenary is the contract. Any month you do not have a contract, including the beginning of the campaign, you may search for what contracts are offered to you. You do not have to accept any of the offers, but you will have to pay this month's Maintenance out of your own Warchest. For the *Mercenaries Box Set*, we have included a pair of contracts, one for each of the opposing players. Upcoming products will have more contracts and rules for creating your own contracts.

GENERAL CONTRACT TERMS

Base Pay: Most contracts have a Base Payment that is paid every month based on an average of 500 SP per month. This is paid each month under contract, including transit times, while in garrison, training, repairing, etc. The Base Pay is based on and provided to cover the maintenance costs of the mercenaries and includes salaries, the upkeep and care of personnel, and the upkeep and care of the equipment. Any shortfalls in Base Pay, from the employer paying less than 100 percent Base Pay, need to be covered by the players. Any overage in Base Pay, for higher Base Pay percentage or combat mission bonuses for example, is kept by the players to pay for other costs or to spend as they see fit.

Maintenance Costs: The standard cost for maintenance is 500 SP per month, the basis for 100 percent Base Pay. This cost needs to be paid by the player even if not under contract; if they want to wait a month in the hopes of a better contract offer for example, they pay the maintenance cost each month they wait for the "right" contract. The maintenance cost for higher Scale forces is multiplied by the Scale. A Scale 3 force pays 1,500 SP per month in maintenance costs, and 100 percent Base Pay for that force will be 1,500 SP.



CHAOS CAMPAIGN: MERCENARIES

Combat Pay: Money that is paid upon completion of a track. Combat payment is based upon and equal to the negotiated Base Pay of the contract. If the negotiated Base Pay is 110 percent, 550 SP, then the Combat Pay is also 550 SP.

If the player succeeds in the track by completing at least one objective and scoring more Victory Points (see p. 26) than the other side, the player receives the full Combat Pay.

If the player achieves *all* their objectives, then the player receives one and a half times (rounded up) the Combat Pay instead. If there is only a single objective, this bonus is paid if the objective is completed, *and* the opponent does not complete any objectives.

If the player is unsuccessful in the track, but does not break contract, the player receives one-half, rounded up, of Combat Pay.

Note: Only one Combat Pay (the highest pay achieved) is paid for each player per track; they are not cumulative. Successfully completing a track with all objectives is worth 150 percent of Base Pay (for completing all objectives), not 250 percent (successful track and all objectives).

Transportation Costs: These are paid to reach the contract location. This is typically 300 SP for JumpShip and DropShip costs to reach the destination. They are only paid once per contract. At higher Scales, the transport cost is multiplied by the Scale of the force. A Scale 2 force pays 600 SP for transportation costs.

Tracking Jumps: If using one of the system maps of the *BattleTech* universe to plot where the campaign is heading, the players may wish to have the cost vary with the number of jumps needed to reach the location of the contract from the players' current location, at 50 SP + 50 SP per jump. Note that while transportation costs will increase with more jumps, every four jumps (rounded up) will require a month of travel and a month of being paid under contract. The total transport cost is multiplied by the Scale of the force.

Support: Support terms are to help cover the mercenaries' battle damage and include repair costs and battlefield loss compensation.

Repair Costs: These costs as are detailed in *Time Between Tracks* (see p. 29) and include any SP Activity listed as repair, heal, or rearm. Repair costs are covered by the Support terms of a mercenary contract. If the Support term lists Straight/100 percent or Battle with any percentage, then all repair costs are covered in their entirety. A Support term of Straight with a percentage will cover that percentage of repair costs.

Battlefield Losses: These costs include any SP Activity listed as purchase or hire if they are used to replace a destroyed unit (of the same type). If the Support term lists Battle with a percentage, then that percentage of Battlefield Loss costs are paid by the employer. The employer will pay the percentage of the cost to purchase the lost unit.

Salvage: Salvage rights cover the equipment recovered from the enemy. Salvage is valued at its selling price, and then the salvage rights percentage is applied to divide it as closely as possible to percentage rights (see *Repairs, Purchasing, Salvage, and Other Expenses*, p. 29). If the salvage rights are listed as Exchange, the mercenary gets none of the salvage, but gets paid one-quarter the salvage value instead. The SP from Exchange rights must be used for repair costs this month or is lost.

Command: Command Rights determine how much control the employer exerts over the command decisions of the mercenaries. Independent command is a true freelancer: do the job and get

OF MERCENARY MIND

Keep in mind that you are a mercenary. You do not have a House or Clan supporting you; you need money. Do not lose more than you can be paid. The mercenary campaign doesn't expect you to "win" every battle, but it does punish needlessly getting your 'Mechs destroyed. Often the question is not can you win, but what will it cost you.

Your opponent is usually a mercenary as well. Having a good Reputation with other mercenaries can be invaluable. Offer the opportunity for your opponent to yield the battlefield, and perhaps they will return the favor when the tables are turned. If you salvage an opponent's 'Mech, and it's not something you wanted to pay the cost for anyway, offer to sell it back to the player (a ransom).

In short, you are not necessarily rewarded for destroying your opponent. You are a mercenary and need to consider the employer's objectives, what they are paying you to do, and decide what risks are worthwhile to take in achieving them—and when those risks are no longer worth the pay. This is how you become a successful mercenary.

the pay. Liaison means an official is detached to represent the employer with the mercenaries and monitor their work and verify the mercenaries' actions. House command means the mercenaries are placed under the employer's command; they will detail when, where, and how the mercenaries will attack. But it is still at the level of the mercenary commander's answers to the House Command. The employer must follow the chain of command. Finally, Integrated command means the employer has practically full command, where the mercenaries' full force is considered to be members of the employer's command and must individually follow any orders given by the employer. The employer may give orders to individual

CAMPAIGN FLOWCHART

Once per Contract

- Negotiate the Contract
- Transportation Costs

Once per Month

- Maintenance Costs
- Collect Base Pay
- Play Track(s)

After Track Completion

- Collect Combat Pay
- Reputation
- Salvage
- Support Costs

After Contact Completion

- Training Activities
- New Contract

CHAOS CAMPAIGN: MERCENARIES

lances or mercenaries if they choose to do so. The effects of Command Rights will be detailed in the contract's Mission Briefing.

NEGOTIATING A CONTRACT

The contract will have default payment and support terms. The player may negotiate some changes to these terms. For every point of Reputation (initially 1), the player may increase one payment or Support type by one step (see Contract Steps Table, p. 23). The amount of Reputation that can be applied to a contract is a maximum of twice the Scale of the contract. At the initial Scale of 1, up to 2 Reputation can be used to modify a contract. Each player negotiates their own contract separately.

In addition, the player may sacrifice two steps in any one contract term to increase another contract term by one step. This swap can be done a maximum of twice to exchange two steps each in two different payment or support types (or four in one type) to increase one or two different payment or support types a total of two steps. If a step has —, then that step cannot be selected, and so you must drop or raise enough steps to reach the next step, even if it is more steps than you can use. For example, it is one step to upgrade the Command Rights from House to Liaison. If you want to reach Independent Command Rights, you need to find another 3 steps to reach an 11. Steps 9 and 10 do not get you anything. If you want to decrease Command Rights from House, you get nothing for steps 6, 5, or 4. You drop 4 steps to get to Integrated Command Rights.

Once the negotiations are complete, the player has an accepted contract. The Mission Briefing for the contract will then list how to generate tracks with the contract.

Each Mission Briefing will list the Intensity, or number of tracks to be played during the contract. This may be a set number or a random number. The track will determine the number of mapsheets and objectives for the track. There may be Special Rules that modify the track, including the effects of Command Rights.

Note: A sample blank Contract Record Sheet is included for the players to fill out at the start of and throughout the campaign. In addition, an in-universe Contract of Mercenary Employment is provided if the players wish to use it.

GREAT EAGLE GARRISON

Contract #: 000001A

Employer: Great Eagle AgroWorks Union

The Great Eagle AgroWorks Union was an independent corporation that was subsumed into the Jade Falcon Occupation Zone when Zhongshan fell to the Clan. Considered a low priority for the Clan military needs, the company was left largely intact for its operations. Much of the executive leadership and corporate owners fled the system, and the worker's union took control of operations.

Laborer Michael serves as the new "Liaison Office" of the Great Eagle, as he first proposed the idea of hiring mercenaries to defend against the sudden pirate attack. With no military experience, Michael has kept the mission details simple, defend the Great Eagle from possible attacks.

Location (Primary Terrain): Zhongshan, former Clan Jade Falcon Occupation Zone (Grasslands)

Type of Action: Garrison

Length of Contract: 3 months

Base Pay: 100% (7)

Support: 0% (1)

Transportation: 100% (9)

Salvage Rights: 50% (8)

Command Rights: Liaison (8)

The Great Eagle AgroWorks extends from the Pearl River Delta east into the Eagle Mountains. You will be expected to rotate garrisons among the villages housing the employees of the Great Eagle and intercept any pirate raids anywhere within the Pearl River basin. The basin is primarily a river floodplain controlled by several concrete dams providing hydroelectric power for the Great Eagle AgroWorks. Smaller villages dot the basin, and these often have well cared for forested parks. Small roads cross the basin, and a great highway runs alongside the Pearl River to the city of Zuhai.

Arthur's mercenaries take their first mercenary contract, the Great Eagle Garrison. He uses the one term step bump from his Reputation of 1 to increase the Base Pay from 100 percent (7) to 110 percent (8). He is a little uncertain about giving up any Command Rights, but the contract already has no support rights, and he's unwilling to give up salvage rights to remove the liaison requirement. It is all about the money, and the Henshin Tigers have accepted the first contract.

Arthur pays for his first month's maintenance, 500 SP. He also collects his travel month's pay. The base is 500 SP, but the contract

pays 110 percent, 550 SP. He spends the first month traveling to the contract location, but the contract covers 100 percent (would have cost 300 SP, but the contract pays 300 SP of it). All clear so far!

Having arrived at the contract location, Arthur moves to the first month of the contract. He pays this month's maintenance, which is again 100 percent covered by the contract plus 50 SP, and he is feeling good about negotiating that Base Pay increase. He has earned 100 SP just traveling to the contract location!

Arthur's mercenary life continues on page 31 as he conducts his first battle.

CHAOS CAMPAIGN: MERCENARIES

PEARL DRAGON RAID

Contract #: 000001A-B

Employer: Pearl Dragon Mining Corporation

The Pearl Dragon Mining Corporation has a long history on Zhongshan but was forced off-world when Clan Jade Falcon invaded. Their stock plummeted, and the company disappeared for years.

The company re-emerged in the past year, with several of the former owners claiming their former interests on Zhongshan. The Pearl Dragon Mining Corporation employed a newly formed security force to the system to claim the highest value targets. Chief Security Officer Harry Wilson has tendered the offer for a mercenary contract to deal with Clan sympathizers on Zhongshan that object to the Pearl Dragon reclaiming their property.

Location (Primary Terrain): Zhongshan, former Clan Jade Falcon Occupation Zone (Grasslands)

Type of Action: Raid

Length of Contract: 3 months

Base Pay: 100% (7)

Support: 0% (1)

Transportation: 0% (5)

Salvage Rights: 70% (10)

Command Rights: Liaison (8)

The Pearl Dragon Mining Corporation is dealing with Clan sympathizing squatters on its property. The Great Eagle AgroWorks Union refuses to acknowledge the stolen property. The Pearl Dragon wants the union to negotiate a return to work and the dissolution of the union. You will target the processing plants of AgroWorks. These losses will bring AgroWorks to the negotiation table.

The Great Eagle AgroWorks extends from the Pearl River Delta east into the Eagle Mountains. You will be expected to attack the scattered agricultural stations of AgroWorks. The basin is primarily a river floodplain controlled by several concrete dams providing hydroelectric power for the Great Eagle AgroWorks. Smaller villages dot the basin, and these often have well cared for forested parks. Small roads cross the basin, and a great highway runs alongside the Pearl River to the city of Zuhai.

ZHONGSHAN

Star Type (Recharge Time): K4V (195 hours)

Position in System: 1 (of 11)

Time to Jump Point: 4.31 days

Number of Satellites: 0

Surface Gravity: 1.1

Atm. Pressure: Standard (Breathable)

Equatorial Temperature: 35°C (Temperate)

Surface Water: 51%

Recharge Station: Nadir

HPG Class: B

Highest Native Life: Amphibians

Population: 1,825,000 (3150)

Socio-Industrial Levels: A-B-B-B-C (3150)

Landmasses (Capital City): Hé De

(Zuhai), Scott's Rocks, Eastland, Guangdong, Pelican's Roost

Zhongshan was named by settlers from Terra before the Formation of the Star League. The population of Zhongshan clusters along the coastline of the largest continent, Fong. The capital of Zuhai sits upriver from the delta of the Pearl Dragon River, surrounded by the farms and grasslands of the delta. The many tributaries of the Pearl Dragon make the area fertile for feeding the population of Zuhai.

The golden age of the Star League brought many important flora and fauna to the areas around settlements. These settlements grew and prospered but remain scattered oases. The main native life are the many amphibians that inhabit the marshes, rivers, lakes, and coastlines that hold most of the surface water on Zhongshan. The Dragon Frogs of the Pearl River, with colorful frills running the length of their bodies, grow up to 3m long and weigh over 200kg. They roam the grasslands in their adult life and return to the river to lay their eggs. The breeding season is a time of celebration in Zhongshan. Explorers, real and imagined, will tell tales of larger amphibians in the wild including immense beasts that live in the ocean and swallow ships whole.

CHAOS CAMPAIGN: MERCENARIES

CONTRACT STEPS TABLE

Step	Base Pay	Command Rights	Salvage Rights	Support Rights	Transportation Terms
1	50%	—	None	None	—
2	55%	—	—	Straight/20%	—
3	60%	Integrated	Exchange	Straight/40%	—
4	70%	—	10%	Straight/60%	—
5	80%	—	20%	Straight/80%	0%
6	90%	—	30%	Straight/100%	25%
7	100%	House	40%	Battle/10%	50%
8	110%	Liaison	50%	Battle/20%	75%
9	120%	—	60%	Battle/30%	100%
10	130%	—	70%	Battle/40%	—
11	150%	Independent	80%	Battle/50%	—
12	175%	—	90%	Battle/75%	—
13	200%	—	100%	Battle/100%	—

GREAT EAGLE GARRISON AND PEARL DRAGON RAID MISSION BRIEF

Contract #: 000001B

Intensity (Number of Tracks): 2–3

Behind the Scenes: These two contracts are opposing contracts. Both sides will be player-controlled mercenaries. The player with the Great Eagle Garrison contract will be called “Great Eagle” and the player with the Pearl Dragon Raid as “Pearl Dragon.”

The conflict is fairly low intensity, but constant. Each month of the contract, roll 1D6 to determine the type of track. If Pearl Dragon successfully completed the last track played, subtract one from the roll. If Great Eagle successfully completed the last track, add one to the roll.

Then roll 2D6 to determine the mapsheet to be played on. The track will then tell you how to determine each player's home edge.

TRACK TABLE

1D6	Track	Attacker/Defender
0–1	Strike	Pearl Dragon/Great Eagle
2–3	Objective Raid	Pearl Dragon/Great Eagle
4–5	Meeting Engagement	Great Eagle/Pearl Dragon
6–7	Defend	Great Eagle/Pearl Dragon

MAPSHEET TABLE

2D6	Mapsheet
2–3	Lake Area
4–5	River Valley
6	Grasslands #2
7–8	Grasslands #3
9–10	Scattered Woods
11–12	Woodland

CHAOS CAMPAIGN: MERCENARIES

Each player then rolls 1D6 to determine possible complications. Add 1 if the player has Liaison Command, 2 for House Command, and 3 for Integrated Command.

COMMAND COMPLICATIONS TABLE

1D6	Complication
1-3	No Complication.
4	The mercenaries are ordered to stand for inspection the day of the attack and are at a -2 to Initiative rolls for the first two turns due to the resulting confusion.
5	The employer's command has a leak, and the raiders are prepared to face the mercenaries. Two additional Galleon GAL-100 tanks are in the opposing force.
6	The employer is putting pressure on the player to produce results quickly. Rushing to the defense, only half (rounded up) of the player's units may deploy on Turn 1. The remainder may move onto the map on Turn 2.
7	The employer picked a momentous day for an attack. Unfortunately, it ended up being a torrential downpour. After several days, it finally lets up, and you are given the order to attack. Any clear, Depth 0 water hexes on your half of the mapsheet are Mud (see below). If there are less than six clear, Depth 0 water hexes, the opposing force player may select other hexes to be Mud to reach at least six Mud hexes.
MUD MP Modifier: A hex covered in Mud adds +1 MP cost per hex. PSRs: Entering a Mud hex forces a Piloting Skill Roll. All PSRs made in a hex with Mud (including the PSR made when entering one) apply a +1 Target Number modifier.	
8+	Roll twice and apply both effects.

SPECIAL RULES

Campaign Victory: If either player successfully completes two tracks in a row, they win the contract. If this happens after only two tracks (two months), there is no track the third month. Their opposition concedes. Otherwise, whichever player has successfully completed two of the three tracks after the third month is the winner.

Temporary Hire: The first time a mercenary force on either of these contracts is unable to field a force of at least 2,000 BV for the next track, a local mercenary will offer their services. The player may choose each track of this contract whether they want to pay the local mercenary to participate in each track or not.

Pearl Dragon: Morlon the Bloody, "bounty hunter" and sometimes mercenary, offers to join the looting and raiding. Morlon pilots a *Quickdraw* QKD-5M and has Piloting 4, Gunnery 4. Morlon demands 50 SPs per track that they participate in and a bonus 25 SPs for each unit they destroy (if they make the attack that destroys the target).

Great Eagle: Tanya claims to have received training in a Clan sibko but refuses to say how she became a mercenary. Tanya pilots an *Ostsol* OTL-5M and has Piloting 5, Gunnery 3. Tanya requires 50 SPs per track that she participates in and a bonus 50 SPs if the track is successful.

PURCHASE OPTIONS

Neither employer has 'Mechs available for purchase. The only new units available are those acquired through salvage or those that happen to be available on the open market at the time. Each month, the player may attempt to find a 'Mech unit available for purchase. Roll 2D6, and on a 7+ there is a 'Mech for sale; on an 11+, there are two.

If you employed a temporary hire for at least one track during this contract and paid them at least one bonus payment, you may permanently hire them at the end of the contract. Morlon and their *Quickdraw* for 1,200 SP or Tanya and her *Ostsol* for 1,200 SP.

Roll 1D6, once for each 'Mech for sale, on the Zhongshan Market Random Allocation Table to determine which 'Mech is available for purchase. This 'Mech is only available for this month. You cannot save up and buy it next month unless you happen to roll it again.

ZHONGSHAN MARKET RANDOM ALLOCATION TABLE

1D6	Chassis/Model	Purchase Cost (SP)
1	Flea FLE-21	400
2	Chameleon CLN-8V	1,000
3	Ostsol OTL-8E	1,200
4	Caesar CES-5R	1,400
5	Starslayer STY-4C	1,500
6	Quickdraw QKD-9G	1,800

CHAOS CAMPAIGN: MERCENARIES

CONTINUING THE MERCENARY CAREER

Players wishing to continue playing may repeat the contracts, swapping sides to play the other side the second time around.

If the players have additional MapPacks or Force Packs, they may also build their own contracts by mixing the provided tracks, available mapsheets, and using new Force Packs units as purchase options. Perhaps the animosity between the Pearl Dragon and Great Eagle leads to outright war in the streets of Zuhai, using the City MapPack. Or perhaps a band of pirates equipped with Clan 'Mechs from the Clan Cavalry Star and Clan Direct Fire Star invade Zhongshan, and the Pearl Dragon and Great Eagle unite against the new enemy.

STREET WAR

Reuse the same contracts and terms for the Great Eagle and Pearl Dragon contracts. If the players have previously played a contract on Zhongshan, there is no transportation cost to move to Street War. The Great Eagle contract offers a 300 SP as a one-time up-front bonus to the mercenary for accepting the Street War contract instead. Replace the mapsheet table with the following:

URBAN MAPSHEET
TABLE

1D6	Mapsheet
1	Corporate Campus (MP: City)
2	Family Quarters (MP: City)
3	HPG Heliport (MP: City)
4	Business District (MP: City)
5	Shopping District (MP: City)
6	HPG Offices (MP: City)

PIRATE INVASION

As the conflict between the Great Eagle and Pearl Dragon winds its way to a possible conclusion, the Roshak Talons invade Zhongshan. Both the Great Eagle and Pearl Dragon offer an emergency contract to the mercenaries to defend the planet, together, against the new enemy.

Either a third player can control the Roshak Talons, or one player can play the combined mercenary force against the Roshak Talons.

The contract terms are 100 percent Base Pay, 100 percent salvage rights, Independent Command Rights, and no Support or Transport rights. For this emergency contract, there is no negotiation; the players either accept the contract or leave the system before the Talons arrive.

This contract is a single Meeting Engagement Track with the Roshak Talons as the Attacker. The players have their choice of battlefield; they can roll on the standard Great Eagle and Pearl Dragon Mission Briefings mapsheets table of the Street War's Urban Mapsheet Table (if they have the City MapPack available). This track will use two mapsheets. The players may align the two mapsheets rolled so that any two long edges are connected.

Each player brings their full Scale 1 force. The Roshak Talons have the following units, and can advance two of them to Gunnery 3, Piloting 4.

Clan Cavalry Star Option: *Griffin IIC*, *Shadow Hawk IIC*, *Locust IIC*, *Jenner IIC*, and three Veteran Elemental battle armor squads.

OR

Clan Direct Fire Star Option: *Kraken (Bane)*, *Grizzly*, and *Phoenix Hawk IIC*.



CHAOS CAMPAIGN: MERCENARIES

TRACKS

A contract has the general situation, while a track is an actual battle. The details of the contract will tell you when a track happens, usually a track each month, and what kind of track. Each track lists the following:

- **Situation:** Describes the in-universe circumstances of the conflict.
- **Game Setup:** Lists how to select home edges and any other rules needed for setting up the track.
- **Objectives:** All tracks have objectives with a Victory Points (VP) value listed in brackets at the end of each description. For *Chaos Campaign: Mercenaries*, these points are only used to determine a successful track. If the player completes at least one objective and scores more VP from objectives than the other side, they have successfully completed the track. They gain Reputation (see p. 19) and receive their Combat Pay (see p. 20) as a bonus based on their completion of objectives.
- **Special Rules:** Indicates which Special Rules are in play for that track. These do not confer a WP bonus to the players.

MAPSHEETS

Which mapsheet(s) to use is detailed in the Mission Briefing details (see p. 23). If additional mapsheets are needed for multiple players, each side should take turns selecting the additional mapsheets, starting with the Attacker.

ENTERING THE PLAYING AREA

If a track's Game Setup requires a force to "enter through their home edge in Initiative order," the loser of the Initiative roll for the first turn moves a unit onto the playing area first, then the winner moves a unit, and so on.

Units entering the mapsheet in this way must pay Movement Points (MP) for the first whole hex they enter—1 MP if it is a Clear hex, 2 MP if it contains Light Woods, and so on. They do not need to pay additional MP if their desired entry hex is above or below Level 0; assume that the unit is entering the hex from another hex of the same Level.

Any number of units may use the same entry hex, provided they each end up in their own hex at the end of their movement. Unless the Game Setup indicates otherwise, any whole hex along a force's home edge is an eligible entry hex.

DEPLOYING PRIOR TO INITIATIVE

If a track's Game Setup requires a force to "deploy prior to Initiative," that side's units must be placed on the map before Initiative is rolled. This often occurs when the Defenders have taken up positions on the playing area and face an assault from the Attacking side.

If the Game Setup does not indicate any restrictions for deployment, the force may place its units anywhere on the playing area. Players will usually want to take up an ideal position when this option presents itself.

RETREAT AND ENDING THE GAME

Any unit may voluntarily withdraw from play by simply spending MP to reach and exit through its home edge; a unit doing so is removed from play but is not considered destroyed. This allows players to preserve their remaining units once an objective has been achieved or hopelessly lost, without continuing to risk 'Mech or MechWarrior.

Similarly, if both sides mutually agree that the track's objectives have been completed or that no further advantage remains by playing on, they may choose to end the game without requiring all remaining units to exit via their home edges. In addition to saving playing time, this reflects the tone of the Succession Wars, an era in which prudent battlefield commanders will withdraw and allow their opponents to do the same once it is clear no further purpose will be served by continuing the battle.

Note that a game ending by mutual agreement does not entitle either side to claim enemy salvage, as neither can claim to hold the field (see *Salvage*, below). Players claim their own destroyed/crippled equipment in this case.

MechWarriors and crew that survive a destroyed unit are always reclaimed by their own side.

SALVAGE

Salvage is the taking of destroyed (see *Destroyed vs. Truly Destroyed*, p. 29) or crippled (see p. 27) equipment remaining on the battlefield at the end of a track. If only one player (or side) successfully completes the track (see *Objectives*, pp. 27–28), they may claim the battlefield salvage, unless taking salvage is prohibited by the Special Rules section of a track. Players may agree to return destroyed or crippled equipment to the original owner when mutually agreeing to end a track. Sometimes it is better to preserve your force than to lose three 'Mechs trying to capture two wrecks. Players may also ransom back salvage to the original owner, and whatever terms they agree upon.

'Mechs that are salvaged may be repaired.

SPECIAL RULES

The following rules are used for all tracks unless otherwise specified.

COMMANDER

Each force must designate one unit as the commander. In addition to scenario specific rules regarding commanders, if the commander unit is destroyed, that force receives a –2 penalty to Initiative rolls.

FORCED WITHDRAWAL

Most forces will not fight to the last man. Instead, once they have taken significant amounts of damage, they will begin to retreat. The forced withdrawal rules help simulate this situation.

Under forced withdrawal, 'Mechs must retreat from the battlefield when rendered useless or in imminent danger of destruction (see *Crippling Damage*, p. 27). A 'Mech making a forced withdrawal must always move toward its home map edge. However, the 'Mech need not spend Running MP, and it may retreat moving backward.

CHAOS CAMPAIGN: MERCENARIES

Withdrawing 'Mechs may still attack an enemy 'Mech that closes within range of a weapon or physical attack.

Crippling Damage: Any 'Mech that suffers crippling damage must withdraw from the map. Crippling damage is defined as one or more of the following:

- Four or more points of damage to the MechWarrior.
- The destruction of all sensor critical slots.
- One gyro and one engine critical hit.
- Two engine critical hits.
- A side torso location is destroyed.
- Internal structure damage in either three or more limbs or two or more torso locations (torso internal structure damage does not count toward crippling damage if that location still has front armor).
- The loss of all weapons. This is triggered if a 'Mech loses all weapons (either through damage or ammunition depletion) with a range greater than five hexes and if it can no longer cause more than 5 points of combined weapons damage. This does not apply if the 'Mech does not start with the ability to do 5 or more damage or the ability to do damage at a range greater than five hexes; in this case, the 'Mech can never trigger this condition.

If using these rules, when all a 'Mech's weapons are destroyed and it can no longer move, the 'Mech is considered destroyed. This is in addition to the regular rules for determining whether a 'Mech is destroyed.

DEFEND

GAME SETUP

The Defender selects a short edge as their home edge, and the Attacker gets the opposite short edge as their home edge.

ATTACKER

The Attacker's force enters from their home edge at the start of the track.

DEFENDER

The Defender holds up to 25 percent of their force off the map at the start of the track. The remainder of their units are deployed prior to Initiative within 12 hexes of their home edge. The held units are placed anywhere on the Defender's half of the play area after the completion of the Movement Phase of Turn 1 as if they had moved 0 hexes or used standstill movement.

OBJECTIVES

Turn the tide (Attacker): Destroy/Cripple at least 75 percent of the Defender's force. [500]

Cut off the head (Attacker/Defender): Destroy/Cripple the enemy commander's unit. [150]

Hold (Defender): At the end of Turn 8, have at least 50 percent of the Defender's unit survive and not be in forced withdrawal and be within 4 hexes of the center line of the battlefield. [400]

SPECIAL RULES

TRACK END

This track ends after the End Phase of Turn 8.

MEETING ENGAGEMENT

GAME SETUP

The Defender selects a short edge as their home edge, and the Attacker gets the opposite short edge as their home edge.

ATTACKER

The Attacker enters the battlefield from the Attacker's home edge during the Movement Phase of Turn 1. Attacking units may only exit via home edge; exiting via any other edge for any reason counts as unit destruction.

DEFENDER

The Defender enters the battlefield from the Defender's home edge during the Movement Phase of Turn 1. Defending units may only exit via home edge; exiting via any other edge for any reason counts as unit destruction.

OBJECTIVES

Make their Acquaintance (Attacker/Defender): The first team that destroys or cripples half of the opponent's force. Units that voluntarily withdraw from the map count as destroyed or crippled for this objective. [200]

SPECIAL RULES

TRACK END

The track ends after the end of any turn where at least one side has no units in play or after the End Phase of Turn 12.

STRIKE

GAME SETUP

The Defender selects a short edge as their home edge, and the Attacker gets the opposite short edge as their home edge. The Defender designates (or places if the map has no appropriate buildings already) 4 Medium buildings within 3 hexes of the center of the battlefield. The buildings take 30 damage before being destroyed and are immobile (-4 Target Number modifier).

ATTACKER

The Attacker enters half of their force from their home edge at the start of the track. The remainder of the force enters from an edge perpendicular to the home edge during the Movement Phase of Turn 2.

CHAOS CAMPAIGN: MERCENARIES

DEFENDER

The Defender deploys their entire force prior to Initiative anywhere on their half of the battlefield. At least 50 percent must be within 3 hexes of the designated buildings. Secretly designate one of these buildings as headquarters before the start of the track.

OBJECTIVES

Identify and Destroy (Attacker only): Locate (using *Scanning*, see below) and destroy the headquarters building. [200]

Rough up the Place (Attacker/Defender): Destroy/Cripple at least 50 percent of the opponent's force. [100]

Seek and Destroy (Defender only): Destroy/Cripple the Commander. [200]

SPECIAL RULES

The following rules are in effect for this track:

TRACK END

The track ends after the end of any turn where at least 1 side has no units in play or after the end of Turn 10.

SCANNING

Buildings may be scanned to determine if they are the objective. BattleMechs and vehicles may declare a scan on a target building within 2 hexes (4 hexes if the unit has an Active Probe) during the Weapon Attack Phase. The results of the scan are determined during the End Phase of the same turn, provided the unit remains functional and does not have any sensor critical hits. A unit with an Active Probe may fire weapons during the same turn as scanning; otherwise, the unit can only scan. Battle armor and infantry may scan a building if they are adjacent or inside the building. They may not attack the same turn they scan.

When a building is scanned, the Defender reveals whether it is the headquarters objective or not during the End Phase of the turn.

OBJECTIVE RAID

GAME SETUP

The Defender selects a short edge as their home edge, and the Attacker gets the opposite short edge as their home edge. The Defender will place/designate 6 Medium buildings (any height) within 10 hexes of the center of the battlefield.

ATTACKER

The Attacker's force enters from their home edge at the start of the track.

DEFENDER

The Defender begins the track with all units in the playing area. At least half of the Defender's force must be within 6 hexes of the designated buildings. Before the start of the track, the Defender designates 2 of the 6 buildings as the objectives.

OBJECTIVES

Grab the stuff (Attacker only): Each component carried off the Attacker's home edge. [50]

You must pay for that (Defender only): Each Attacker unit destroyed. [50]

SPECIAL RULES

The following rules are in effect for this track:

RAID

An Attacker unit that ends its turn next to an objective building may grab an objective component. How many it may carry is dependent on the unit type, available hands, and any assistance it may get. Assisting units must be infantry and have ended their movement adjacent to the unit grabbing components.

CARRYING CAPACITY

A 'Mech or vehicle unit may carry a maximum number of components equal to its weight class. Light (up to 35 tons) = 1, Medium (40-55 tons) = 2, Heavy (60-75 tons) = 3, Assault (80-100 tons) = 4.

LOADING

It requires time to pick up or load components, depending on the availability of hand actuators and assistance. The following lists the number of components that can be picked up or loaded each turn. If the unit can carry more components, it must spend more turns loading or carry less than its maximum load.

'Mech with no hands or vehicle, without assistance: 0 components.

'Mech with no hands or vehicle, with assistance: 1 component.

'Mech with one hand: 1 component.

'Mech with two hands: 2 components.

EFFECTS OF CARRYING

Non-'Mech units or 'Mech units with no hand actuators carrying components reduce their walking or cruising movement by 1. 'Mech units with hand actuators carrying objective components may not attack with any weapons in the same arm.

TRACK END

The track ends after the end of any turn where at least one side has no units in play, or after the end of Turn 12.



CHAOS CAMPAIGN: MERCENARIES

TIME BETWEEN TRACKS

What happens between tracks can be just as important to a campaign as the games played during the tracks themselves. During the time between tracks, players may use SP to improve their personnel, repair and rearm, and purchase new equipment. SPs may not be spent during gameplay of a track.

When spending SPs between tracks, keep in mind the current contract status. The mercenary command may need time and money to find a new contract.

REPAIRS, PURCHASING, SALVAGE, AND OTHER EXPENSES

Support Points can be used directly to effect repairs and purchase new units or personnel, as shown on the SP Activity Cost Table on page 30.

Repairs: Spending SP to repair a 'Mech's armor or internal structure restores all such damage across the entire 'Mech. The exception is if a player spends SP to repair a 'Mech's armor, and one or more locations still have damage to their internal structure. In that case, all armor is replenished except in the locations with internal damage; those locations do not regain any armor. This may be necessary if SP is running low but means that the player will have to eventually pay SP to repair the 'Mech's internal structure, and then again pay the full SP cost to repair the 'Mech's entire armor. When paying SPs to repair a unit's internal structure, all critical hits are repaired and all internal structure is replenished, even on missing locations. (Hint: whether repairing armor or internal structure, remember that it is all or nothing; sometimes it may be worth it to choose to not repair a unit that has taken very minor damage.)

Repair Time: If there are multiple tracks in the same month, this will limit the repair options available or require some repaired units to miss the next track. If a unit repairs the entire internal structure or heals a MechWarrior wound, that unit is unavailable for the next track.

Purchased Units: The Mission Briefing will tell you what units are available for purchase, if any. Newly purchased units come with a full complement of ammunition. Note that a player is still restricted to the Scale allowed for its force in each track. At Scale 1, the limit is still 3,000 BV. The player may collect more units, but each track is limited to the 3,000 BV of Scale 1. Having more units creates a buffer to replace losses, allows customizing the forces to meet the needs of each specific track, and eventually could lead to the mercenary operating at a higher Scale and fielding more forces per track. See *Changing the Scale* on page 30 for rules on increasing the Scale limit for each track.

New MechWarriors: Newly hired MechWarriors are of Regular quality, with a Gunnery Skill of 4 and a Piloting Skill of 5. A player may hire a Green MechWarrior, with a Gunnery Skill of 5 and a Piloting Skill of 6, for no SP cost.

Salvage: Salvage is valued at its selling price (without repairs or rearming, the base selling price is used as the salvage value), and then the salvage rights percentage from the contract applied to divide it as closely as possible to percentage rights. Where there is a choice, the mercenary may divide the salvage. For the smallest

selling price unit that cannot be split, the player may choose to pay the remaining salvage value and take the unit or take their share of the salvage value as SPs. If the salvage rights are listed as Exchange, the mercenary gets none of the salvage, but gets paid one-quarter the salvage value of any salvage.

DESTROYED VS. TRULY DESTROYED

A unit may be considered "destroyed" during a game. However, there are instances when a unit "destroyed" in terms of a particular game is not truly destroyed in terms of a campaign. In other words, it may be possible for a unit considered destroyed during gameplay to return to operational status through repairs between tracks.

A 'Mech is only truly destroyed when its center torso internal structure is eliminated. In that instance, as noted on the SP Activity Cost Table, it cannot be repaired.

All other damage sufficient to consider a unit "destroyed" during gameplay can be repaired between tracks, including a completely destroyed head location. If the MechWarrior died from wounds, the cockpit being destroyed, or the head location being destroyed, a new MechWarrior will need to be hired or swapped from another 'Mech.

PERSONNEL TRAINING

Between contracts, personnel who participated in the last contract may improve their Gunnery or Piloting Skills by paying the Support Point Costs on the SP Activity Cost Table (see p. 30)..

Personnel who did not participate in the last contract may also improve their Skills but at three times the listed cost in SP.

Personnel may only improve one Skill at a time between contracts. For example, a MechWarrior can improve either their Gunnery or their Piloting Skill by one rating, but they may not advance either Skill by two or more ratings in between tracks nor both Skills by one.

Special Pilot Abilities: A player may purchase any Special Pilot Abilities shown on any MechWarrior Cards from the Mercenaries Box Set or Force Packs. If they do, they will not be able to advance either the Gunnery or the Piloting Skill of that MechWarrior at this time. The MechWarrior receiving a Special Pilot Ability (SPA) must have participated in the preceding contract. A MechWarrior can only have a single Special Pilot Ability with a total SPA cost of 2 or less until they reached Veteran experience (an average Piloting and Gunnery Skill, rounded down, of 3). Veteran pilots may have one or two Special Pilot Abilities with a total SPA cost of 4 or less. If the MechWarrior reaches Heroic experience (an average Piloting and Gunnery Skill, round down, of 1 or less), they may have up to three Special Pilot Abilities with a total SPA cost of 6 or less. Special Pilot Abilities that have multiple uses for additional SPA cost, like Lucky, count as a single Special Pilot Ability with an SPA cost of the number of uses.

FORMATION TRAINING

A command may spend a month where it does not have a track in coordinated training. A small group may train in Formation tactics; if it fulfills the requirements for the Formation and pays the SP activity cost for the training, that group of units is now a Formation and receives the benefits of that Formation. This can also be used to change the Formation type of an existing Formation.

CHAOS CAMPAIGN: MERCENARIES

SP ACTIVITY COST TABLE

Support Activities

Repair 'Mech's Armor (no location at 0 Armor remaining)* = Tonnage/2

Repair 'Mech's Entire Armor* = Tonnage

Repair 'Mech's Internal Structure (no location at 0 Internal Structure remaining)** = Tonnage

Repair 'Mech's Entire Internal Structure** = Tonnage x 2

Purchase 'Mech = Tonnage x 20 (x30 for Clan/Mixed Technology)

Selling a 'Mech*** = Tonnage x 10 (x15 for Clan/Mixed Technology)

Rearm Unit (per ton of ammunition) = 10

Hire a new MechWarrior**** = 100

Heal MechWarrior = 30 per Wound box; 1 per month

* Armor is restored only to locations that do not have internal structure damage.

** 'Mechs whose center torso internal structure has been reduced to 0 cannot be repaired. Paying this cost also repairs all critical hits.

*** A 'Mech must be fully repaired before it can be sold.

**** Does not come with their own 'Mech; a new 'Mech must be purchased or salvaged separately. New MechWarrior is Piloting 5, Gunnery 4.

Personnel Training Activities

MechWarrior Gunnery Skill from 5 to 4† = 100

MechWarrior Gunnery Skill from 4 to 3 = 200

MechWarrior Gunnery Skill from 3 to 2 = 400

MechWarrior Gunnery Skill from 2 to 1 = 800

MechWarrior Piloting Skill from 5 to 4† = 50

MechWarrior Piloting Skill from 4 to 3 = 100

MechWarrior Piloting Skill from 3 to 2 = 200

MechWarrior Piloting Skill from 2 to 1 = 400

Special Pilot Ability = SPA Point Cost x 200

† Same cost is also used for improving any higher Skill by one step (i.e., 6 to 5, 7 to 6, etc.)

Force Training Activities

Create a New Formation = 10 per unit in Formation

Change an Existing Formation = 5 per unit in Formation

Rules for Formations can be found in the *Clan Invasion* box set (see *Force Building*, pp. 16–23) or *Campaign Operations* (see *Formation Building*, pp. 56–68). For the purposes of this rule set, each player must select one organization type—Inner Sphere (lances), Clan (Stars), or ComStar (Level IIs)—and train formations with the number of units in it. The player may have a single over- or under-strength Formation as an exception. For example, an Inner Sphere force organization has four 'Mechs in a lance. A player may have one lance of three 'Mechs and another of four but cannot have two lances of three 'Mechs or a lance of three and a lance of five. The player does not have to field the entire lance in a track, but if a Formation has less than three units fielded during gameplay, whether from not fielding all the units, units being destroyed in combat, or a combination, it loses the benefits of that Formation.

CHANGING SCALE

If the player has enough 'Mechs and has built up the Support Points for a larger force and wants to play larger missions, they may increase the Scale they are operating at (advertise as a larger force, look for bigger contracts). This increases their Scale by 1. This increases the force's size (BV limit) and support (BSP) they can bring to each track.

Meeting Your Opponent at their Scale: If one player is at a lower Scale, the higher Scale player must choose a force for this track following the limits of the lower Scale. If a Scale 2 player is playing against a Scale 1 player, the Scale 2 player must build their force for this track limiting themselves to Scale 1 (3,000 BV and 32 BSP). The bonus pay for this track is paid at the Scale played.

WARCHEST DEBT

If the players do not have enough SPs to pay maintenance or transportation, they may go into Warchest Debt to continue operating.

Players may not purchase services and equipment or improve their MechWarriors with Warchest Debt; the option may only be used to cover maintenance and transportation.

Any SPs gained after incurring debt are used to pay off the debt until the Warchest regains a positive balance.

Players may not go in to Warchest Debt to pay for more than six months without paying off the debt. If a force is already in debt and still cannot pay for maintenance or transportation, there are three options.

- **Sell Assets:** The first option is to sell assets until the force can pay off its debt. Note that repairs while in debt are not permitted, so only units that are already completely undamaged may be sold.

- **Retire:** Second, the player may decide that the force is now retired, and the campaign ends. This may be the appropriate response if selling off assets will reduce the force to such a degree that future tracks are not likely to be fun for the player. Keeping it fun must always be the goal.

- **Skip A Track:** The third option is to have the force skip a track. This is only possible while you are in debt. The force spends its time repairing, refitting, and arranging for the next track. Only repairs may be executed; no additional activities may be performed during a skipped track, even if there is SP available. The players lose 1 Reputation from avoiding the track. The players play the next track of the contract or begin searching for a new contract if they are out of contract. The players are considered one lower Command Rights level (from Liaison to House, from House to Integrated) for this track. The option to skip a track may only be taken once; if the force skips a track, plays a following track, and afterward again cannot afford a subsequent track, they must either sell assets or retire.

CHAOS CAMPAIGN: MERCENARIES



MERCENARY COMMAND SCALE TABLE

Scale	Typical Force	BV	BSP
1	Mixed Lance of 'Mechs and Support	3,000 BV	32 BSP
2	Lance of 'Mechs and Support	6,000 BV	64 BSP
3	Mixed Company	9,000 BV	96 BSP

BREAKING CONTRACT

Sometimes it is obvious that continuing the contract is untenable for one player. Not having enough units to form anywhere near a Scale 1 (3,000 BV) force for the next track is the most obvious example. If the player sees no hope in fighting the next track, they may opt to break the contract. Breaking contract is normally a -3 Reputation penalty. If the player has less than two-thirds of the Scale limit, less than 2,000 BV remaining at Scale 1, this is only a -1 Reputation penalty by invoking an escape clause. The contract ends immediately for the mercenary breaking contract. They no longer get support, Base Pay, etc. for the remainder of the contract. The player may then decide if they want to continue playing this mercenary command or start a new command.

The other player, no longer having an opponent, gains Reputation for having successfully completed the contract. They continue to get support, Base Pay, etc. from the contract for the remaining time of the contract but no bonus pay since they don't actually face combat.

Arthur then looks over the Mission Briefing details for the Great Eagle Garrison contract. The track is randomly rolled and comes up as Strike. Arthur plays the track out with his force and a friend plays theirs as the opposing force. After setting up the track, Arthur rolls for command complications and finds his Liaison Command Rights are going to give him an Initiative penalty in the first couple turns. But hopefully the money will be worth it.

Arthur's Ostsol successfully locates the headquarters for the Strike objective and destroys it. He then withdraws his forces. Having achieved one objective (locate and destroy the HQ) and managing not to get his force destroyed or his commander destroyed, he has 200 VP from objectives versus 0 for the opposing force. This is a successful track! Arthur adds one to his Reputation for a successful track. He completed the one and only objective, and the opponent did not complete any objectives, so Arthur gets 150 percent Base Pay as a combat bonus, 550 times one and a half for 825 SP! This successful track also entitles Arthur to collect salvage. Arthur only has 50 percent salvage rights and only destroyed or crippled a single enemy 'Mech, the Flea. A Flea's selling price is 20 tons times 10 SP for 200 SP. Arthur collects 100 SP for his 50 percent salvage rights and then can choose to pay the 200 SP to keep the (crippled) Flea. Arthur's not so sure the Flea is what he wanted and just keeps the 100 SP.

The Ostsol took some internal and armor damage, and the Caesar took armor damage. The Ostsol's 60 tons * 2 in SP will repair its internal structure, and the 60 tons * 1 will repair its armor. 180 SP in repairs planned for the Ostsol. The Caesar only needs armor repair, but it is 70 tons * 1 for 70 SP. He also wants to rearm one ton of ammunition at 10 SP each for another 10 SP. Arthur needs 260 SP to do the planned repair/rearm tasks. He received 100 SP from selling the salvaged Flea, leaving 160 SP to pay.

He now has his initial 3,000 SP, minus 500 for maintenance pay, plus 550 for Base Pay, minus 300 for travel and plus 300 for travel reimbursement, plus 825 for track bonus and minus 160 for repairs and rearming, for a new total of 3,590 SP. Arthur is ready for month two of paying the bills and fighting the fight.

CHAOS CAMPAIGN: MERCENARIES

BATTLETECH

MERCENARY FORCE
RECORD SHEET



NAME:

Henshin Tigers

CO: Lieutenant Aiko Hatakeyama

Scale: 1 BV Used/Available: 2,832 / 3,000 BSP: 40 Skill ADV: 2

Warchest: 3,765 SP

FORMATION:

Unit	BV	MechWarrior	G/P	Adv	Special Pilot Abilities
Casson CES-30	1587	LT Aiko "Tora"	3/5	1	
Orbital OTL-SM	1245	Damon "Hell" Murray	4/4	1	

FORMATION:

Unit	BV	MechWarrior	G/P	Adv	Special Pilot Abilities

FORMATION:

Unit	BV	MechWarrior	G/P	Adv	Special Pilot Abilities

FORMATION:

Unit	BV	MechWarrior	G/P	Adv	Special Pilot Abilities

© 2023 The Topps Company, Inc. BattleTech, Mech and BattleMech are trademarks of The Topps Company, Inc. All rights reserved.
Catalyst Game Labs and the Catalyst Game Labs logo are trademarks of Infinites Production, LLC. Permission to photocopy for personal use.

BATTLETECH

MERCENARY CONTRACT
RECORD SHEET



Name: Henshin Tigers

Contract: Great Eagle Garrison

Type of Action: Garrison

Scale: 1

Length: 3 Months

Base Pay: 110 % (8) Transportation: 100 % (9) Support: 0 % (1)

Salvage: 50 % (8) Command: Liaison (8)

Starting Warchest: 3,000

Month	Event	Cost	Cover	Paid	Balance	Rep
1	Contract Complete Great Eagle Garrison	—	—	—	—	1
1	Transportation	300 SP	300 SP	0 SP		
1	Maintenance	500 WP	500 SP	450 WP		
1	Track 1-Strike	—	—	—		
1	Maintenance	500 SP	500 SP	450 SP		
1	Successful Track Bonus	0 WP	750 SP	450 SP		+1
1	Salvage: Flea	100 SP	0 SP	100 SP		
1	Repair CES Armor	70 SP	0 SP	70 SP		
1	Repair OTL Internal	120 SP	0 SP	120 SP		
1	Repair OTL Armor	60 SP	0 SP	60 SP		
1	Rearm 1 Tons	10 SP	0 SP	10 SP		
1	End Month 1 Contract	—	—	3,765 SP		+2

COMMON COSTS/PAY

Contact Terms:

Travel: 300 SP x Scale

Mon. Maintenance: 500 SP x Scale

Combat Bonus:

No Obj/Lost Units: 0

1+Obj: 50% Base Pay

Success: 100% Base Pay

All Obj: 150% Base Pay

Support:

Repair All Armor: Ton

Repair All Internal: Ton x 2

Rearm: 10 SP/Ton

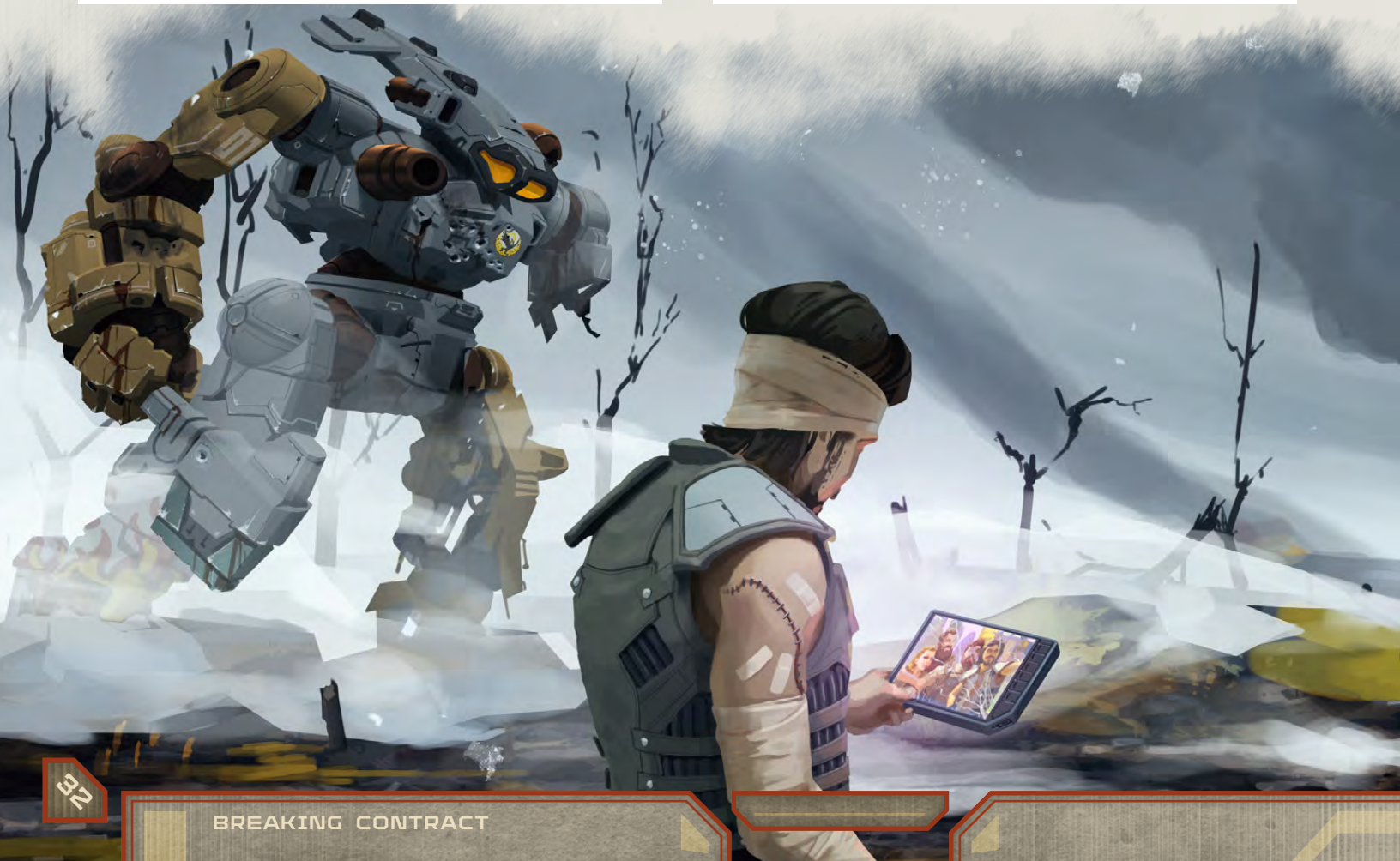
Purchase Mech: Ton x 20

Sell (Repaired) Mech: Ton x 10

Salvage:

Salvage Value: Ton x 10

© 2023 The Topps Company, Inc. BattleTech, Mech and BattleMech are trademarks of The Topps Company, Inc. All rights reserved.
Catalyst Game Labs and the Catalyst Game Labs logo are trademarks of Infinites Production, LLC. Permission to photocopy for personal use.



BREAKING CONTRACT

Name: _____ **Contract:** _____

Type of Action:	Scale:	Length:	Months
-----------------	--------	---------	--------

Base Pay: % () **Transportation:** % () **Support:** % ()

Salvage: % () **Command:** ()

Starting Warchest:

[illegible]

COMMON COSTS/PAY

Contact Terms:

Travel: $300 \text{ SP} \times \text{Scale}$

Mon. Maintenance:

500 SP_xScale

Combat Bonus:

No Obj/Lost Units: 0

1+Obj: 50% Base Pay

Success: 100% Base Pay

All Obj: 150% Base Pay

Support:

Repair All Armor: Ton

Repair All Internal: Ton $\times$ 2

Rearm: 10 SP/Ton

Purchase 'Mech: Tonx20

Sell (Repaired) 'Mech: $\text{Ton} \times 10$

Salvage:

Salvage Value: $Ton \times 10$

NAME: _____

CO: _____

Scale: _____ **BV Used/Available:** _____ / _____ **BSP:** _____ **Skill ADV:** _____

Warchest: _____ **SP**

FORMATION: _____

Unit Abilities	BV	MechWarrior	G/P	Adv	Special Pilot Abilities
_____	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____

FORMATION: _____

Unit Abilities	BV	MechWarrior	G/P	Adv	Special Pilot Abilities
_____	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____

FORMATION: _____

Unit Abilities	BV	MechWarrior	G/P	Adv	Special Pilot Abilities
_____	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____

FORMATION: _____

Unit Abilities	BV	MechWarrior	G/P	Adv	Special Pilot Abilities
_____	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____

CONTRACT OF MERCENARY EMPLOYMENT

This agreement executed between _____ (hereafter designated "Employer") and _____ (hereafter designated "Unit"), provides employment for the Unit military forces in the service of the Employer. This employment is subject to the terms and conditions outlined below.

I. ASSIGNMENT: The Unit is hired for the performance of a mission planned and assigned by the Employer, defined as a(n) _____ contract type under the conventions and usages of contemporary military terminology. Said Unit will perform all operations that fall within the framework of this mission, as well as serving the general interests and needs of the Employer.

II. FORCES: The Unit agrees to provide combat and support forces, estimated at _____ squads of combat and/or combat support troops, as of the date this contract goes into effect. The Employer reserves the right to terminate the agreement if actual forces mustered at the time this contract goes into effect are less than two-thirds of the originally estimated forces or if they exceed the agreed-upon strength by more than 10 percent, unless excess troops serve for no more money than originally designated in this agreement.

III. LENGTH OF SERVICE: This contract will remain in effect for _____, commencing on _____ and concluding on _____.

On the commencement date, the Unit agrees to be located on _____. The Employer agrees to pay _____ percent of the transportation costs incurred by the Unit to reach the location. Upon termination of the agreement, the Unit will be discharged from all duties and responsibilities to the Employer, unless discharge is superseded by a new agreement.

IV. REMUNERATION: The Employer agrees to pay _____ per month to the Unit. This money is to be held in escrow agreed upon by both parties. Combat bonuses based on this amount will be paid for engaging in combat (one-half), successfully completing the defined objectives of the combat (one-half), and for exemplary service (another one-half) for a maximum combat bonus of one and a half times the monthly remuneration.

V. SUPPORT: The Employer agrees to provide _____ percent of the logistical support of the Unit. The Employer will reimburse the Unit for the amount of C-bills if the Unit provides its own supplies. Resupply of munitions and other specific battlefield matériel after each major battle or campaign shall consist of _____ percent over and above said supply requirements.

VI. TRANSPORTATION: The Employer agrees to provide for _____ percent of the interstellar and/or interplanetary transport of the Unit. The Employer shall pay the Unit any standard and customary costs to reimburse the Unit for providing transport for the Unit or any part thereof.

VII. SALVAGE RIGHTS: All enemy combat equipment recovered during the operation of this contract shall be divided between the Employer and the Unit, with the unit receiving _____ percent of the estimated market value of the equipment.

VIII. COMMAND RIGHTS: The Unit hereby agrees to command structures of the following nature:

The Unit is guaranteed to retain internal coherence and consistency of its command structure within the usual limits of this assigned command status.

IX. BATTLEFIELD CONDUCT: The Unit agrees to battlefield conduct as set forth by the Ares Conventions. Any violations of said conventions are solely the responsibility of the Unit and render this contract and further payments null and void.

X. OTHER TERMS: Other terms of this contract, agreed to by both parties, shall be negotiated on a case-by-case basis, individual signed and witnessed, as riders to this document.

Signed at _____ on this _____ day of _____, in the year _____

Unit Commander _____

Signed at _____ on this _____ day of _____, in the year _____

Employer _____

Witnessed by: _____